
MH@MERICS · WEEK 27 · 2026

Weekly Update

29 Jun – 5 Jul 2026

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I. Highlights

Spotlight

China-related foreign economic policy has moved onto the reform-package agenda. The reform package agreed by the coalition committee on July 2 (“*Programm für Aufschwung und Beschäftigung*”) devotes item 17 (“*Außenwirtschaft und Handelsschutz*”) to a set of external-economic-policy China instruments – a striking inclusion in a domestic-recovery package, signalling how far these questions have risen on the coalition’s political agenda. The instruments listed: faster and sector-wide anti-dumping and anti-subsidy proceedings at EU level, tighter rules against circumvention, case-by-case mandatory technology-transfer requirements for non-European investment in strategic sectors and critical infrastructure, accelerated adoption of the Industrial Accelerator Act, EU-preference clauses in public support programmes, and guaranteed state offtake (“*Staat als Ankerkunde*”) in strategically important areas.

Vice-Chancellor and Finance Minister **Lars Klingbeil** supplied the political framing: “I called for a more robust course towards China weeks ago, and we are now implementing it.” In strategically important areas such as infrastructure and defence, the government will lean on European production – “local content”. Germany wants open trade, but “we will not accept that others do not play by the rules and use unfair means to destroy jobs and business models here”.

The vocabulary – tougher line, EU frame, instruments over principles – aligns with the Brussels timetable demanding “tangible results” from Beijing by October on trade imbalances, raw-materials export controls and market access.

German China policy in context

GERMANY

- **Verfassungsschutzbericht 2025 elevates China science and research espionage** – The BfV annual report and Table.Briefings’ analysis both flag Beijing’s use of grey zones and academic freedom for research spying, with universities as the systemic vulnerability.
- **German carmakers begin historic job cuts as Chinese rivals cross 10% EU market share** – FT reports VW is set to double its planned cuts to 100,000 (with production ending at four German plants); BMW and Mercedes are also cutting thousands as simultaneous China volume losses and faster-than-expected Chinese penetration force parallel restructuring across all three German majors.
- **WSJ backdrop – Germany’s shift from free-trade orthodoxy to sectoral protection**: A Dec 2025 WSJ synthesis by Tom Fairless and Bertrand Benoit lays out the arc Reformpaket §17 now codifies: BDI reclassifying China as “systemic competitor” (2019), VDMA calling for antidumping and sanctions (2025), Merz National Security Council (new) working on critical-minerals diversification, and the structural indicators driving the pivot – manufacturing output down 14% from its 2017 peak, industrial-sector jobs down ~5% since 2019, and Germany’s 2025 goods-and-services trade deficit with China on track for a record €88bn

(~\$102bn). Rhodium's Noah Barkin flags the "Shanghai syndrome" risk – Berlin defaulting back to appeasement if Trump proves unreliable.

- **Berlin summons Chinese envoy over PLA training of Russian forces** – Following the [Reuters exclusive](#) on Belousov-approved training linked to the Ukraine war, the Auswärtiges Amt held urgent talks with China's ambassador.

EU INSTITUTIONAL

- **October deadline for Beijing to deliver "tangible results" on trade imbalances** – Šefčovič set a hard clock on the [new consultation mechanism](#) launched Jun 29. [Bloomberg](#) and [the Guardian](#) frame it as a three-month window before EU retaliation.
- **Von der Leyen: EU will retaliate if Beijing misses the deadline** – [Euronews interview](#). EPP group chair [Manfred Weber](#) warns of "trade conflict"; chief trade MEP [Bernd Lange](#) calls the deadline "not realistic at all" – early divergence inside Parliament.
- **Wang Wentao–Šefčovič inaugural meeting of the new China-EU consultation mechanism** – MOFCOM [confirmed](#) one-to-two ministerial meetings per year going forward; second meeting in China this autumn.
- **Beijing signals openness to reducing the EU trade surplus** – [SCMP](#) reads Beijing's Brussels tone as more accommodating than the state-media commentary suggests; [FT](#) reports the Chinese line that it can "withstand" a trade freeze if talks fail.
- **New EU steel safeguards proposed against global overcapacity** – The Commission [tabled tighter measures](#) with China as the implicit primary target.
- **€3 parcel duty on low-value imports live from 1 July** – [Guardian](#). Direct hit on Shein / Temu channels.
- **CCCEU: Brussels is shifting to "conditional openness and controlled access" for Chinese investment** – [Caixin](#) · [Chinese CCCEU version](#).
- **EU and US voice joint concern over China's extraterritorial ethnic unity law** – [Reuters](#); Brussels calls the law's overseas reach a breach of international law, Washington calls it "problematic".
- **EU chip sector faces a "bleak future" without swift domestic supply build-out** – EUISS + Institut Montaigne [report](#) names Chinese export controls on critical minerals, Taiwan Strait risk, and US-dependence on ASML as the three-way threat.
- **Chinese automakers overtake Japanese rivals in Europe despite EV tariffs** – [Nikkei](#). H1 2026: Chinese brands 138,410 vs Japanese 130,424; BYD H1 overseas sales +70%.
- **Europe's sleepwalk toward a second China shock** – [Louis Puel op-ed in Le Grand Continent](#) frames the current EU–China stance as inadequate to the pace of Chinese industrial displacement.
- **Nikkei "5 things" primer** – [Are the EU and China heading for a trade war?](#) – accessible framing for the debate.
- **WSJ: Europe learns it's hard to start a trade war with China during a heat wave** – [WSJ](#) – Chinese AC exports softened the political appetite for confrontation just as Šefčovič's team was hardening the line.

EU MEMBER STATES

- **France passes fast-fashion bill targeting Shein and Temu** – [Caixin](#). Per-item penalties + ad restrictions; still awaiting presidential promulgation.
- **Wang Yi tours Denmark, Sweden, Finland, Norway (2–8 July)** – [Reuters](#); [Nikkei read-across](#) frames the trip as a test of Europe's "Nordic hawks" while Berlin and Brussels harden.

MERICS

MERICS RESEARCH AND (MEDIA) INSIGHTS

The EU must confront China's trade challenge. Three urgent reasons why the EU must tackle China's destabilizing economic imbalances now; delaying to 2027 is not an option. (*Comment, Jul 01*)

Fragmented Europe: Dealing with China as a technology and innovation power — the **European Think-tank Network on China (ETNC)** annual report, edited by Bernhard Bartsch and Claudia Wessling, with MERICS analysts contributing four chapters examining national approaches to dealing with China as a technological power and research partner. Recent years have seen the EU shift toward a policy of “de-risking” cooperation with China in science and technology. (*Report, Jun 30*)

- **Executive Summary.** China's drive to become a global leader in science, technology and innovation has huge implications for the EU and its member states.
- **EU chapter: Shepherded by Brussels, Europe awakens to Chinese technology** — **Rebecca Arcesati** explores EU-China interactions in technology and innovation amid intense geopolitical rivalry in three case studies: foundational semiconductors, battery electric vehicles, and energy infrastructure. The exclusion of Chinese entities from large parts of Horizon Europe and heightened investment scrutiny mark a wider shift from unconditional openness to a logic of “de-risking” and economic security.
- **Germany chapter: From mutual benefit to existential competition with China** — **Claudia Wessling** and **Bernhard Bartsch** find that after decades of lucrative technology cooperation, Germany faces an existential crisis. Fears of losing key industries drive soul-searching about competitiveness, but diverging strategies emerge along political/business fault lines: government pivots toward security politics and geoeconomics while many companies and research institutions double down on Chinese partners, judging the risks of *not* cooperating as higher.
- **Ireland chapter: Interlocking factors shape the approach to China in science-tech innovation** — **Alexander Davey** with **Niall Duggan** assess that Ireland's approach is shaped by its FDI-driven economic model, a growing set of security-and-competitiveness strategies, pressure to diversify amid US-administration uncertainty, and wider resilience-building against geopolitical instability.
- **Italy chapter: Biopharma, automotive and telecoms sectors face China's technological power** — **Aurelio Insisa** with a former IAI colleague on Italy's relation with China's growing tech power. Securitization remains the frame, within and beyond the government's ever-expanding “golden power”. Italy will remain one of the countries most exposed to Chinese industrial plans for 2026-30.

Whatever happened to balanced trade? Issue 254 — in collaboration with MERICS. A decade ago China's leadership argued that stronger domestic demand would lead to more imports and more balanced trade; those speeches are still in the official archives, but the trade data tell a different story. (*Soapbox, Jun 29*)

MERICS EVENTS

Kiel-MERICS Policy Panel

CTO Workshop on Semiconductors

Strategic Industries Dialogue and Dinner

Advancing Economic Security Forum 2026

SELECTED INSIGHTS FOR MEDIA BY COLLEAGUES

Antonia Hmaidi quoted by **Associated Press Newswires** on Nvidia losing significant ground to Huawei in China's domestic AI-chip market.

Claus Soong quoted by **The Straits Times** on the new EU-China consultation mechanism as Beijing's attempt to keep dialogue with the EU open.

Investor's Business Daily cited **Wendy Chang** on Chinese AI firms' wide-diffusion, cheap-token strategy to gain global market share.

Antonia Hmaidi quoted by **Wirtschaftswoche** on why China views leadership in the fourth industrial revolution and AI as strategically vital.

Kristin Shi-Kupfer quoted by **Deutschlandfunk** on the Dalai Lama's continued political relevance despite no longer heading a state.

Congressional Documents & Publications cited MERICS's report *Beyond overcapacity: Chinese-style modernization and the clash of economic models* (April 2025) in a US House competitiveness hearing memo.

Rafael Jimenez Buendia quoted by **Deutsche Welle** on China's decade-long rhetoric of "balanced trade" with Europe.

Daria Impiombato quoted by **Neue Zürcher Zeitung** on China's influence operations targeting US AI discourse.

Formiche cited **Aurelio Insisa** on Italy's technological relationship with Beijing (+ 2 further Italian outlets).

Andrew Scobell op-ed in **Política Exterior** on Xi's Pyongyang visit and North Korea's rehabilitation.

Simon Nguyen quoted by **Süddeutsche Zeitung** on EU export controls and the Nexperia saga.

MERICS INSTITUTIONALLY CITED (NO NAMED EXPERT)

Swissinfo (SRG SSR) cited MERICS as Europe's largest independent research institute focused on contemporary China, in a piece on Switzerland's weak China-research infrastructure.

Organiser (India) on China's strategic shift from improving living standards toward patriotism and military preparedness.

China Business Spotlight on warnings about China's economic challenge to Europe.

T-Online referenced the MERICS *China Security and Risk Tracker 01/2026*.

Chart 1 – China’s semiconductor equipment domestic substitution accelerated after 2019 (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255 – Jul 6 2026; share of domestic equipment in Chinese SME purchases, 2015–2026).

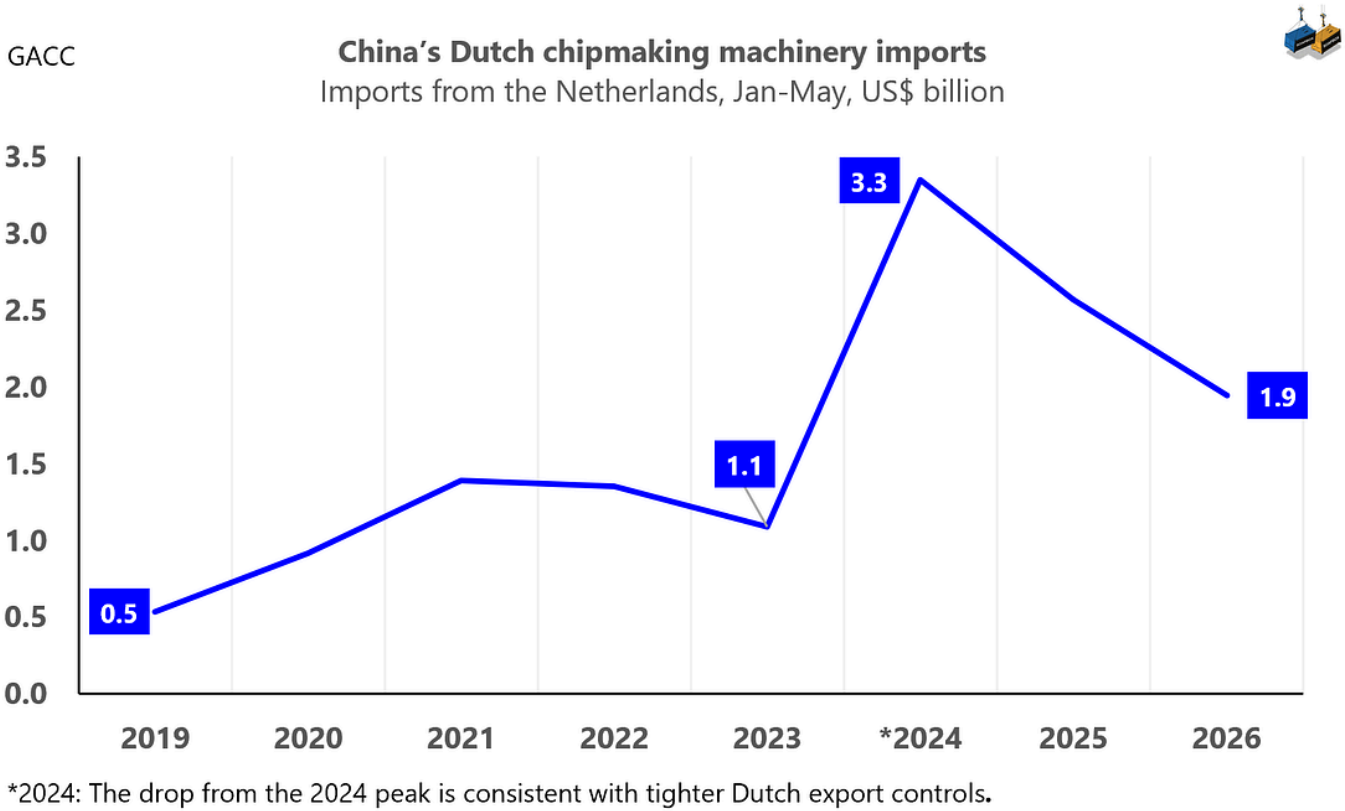


Chart 2 – China’s Ga/Ge licensing regime hit values, not volumes: CN 38180090 physical volume barely changed while unit value nearly doubled (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255; EU imports under CN 38180090 from China, quantity and value, Jan 2022 – Apr 2026).

EUROSTAT

EU suppliers of 3818 0090, by value, € million

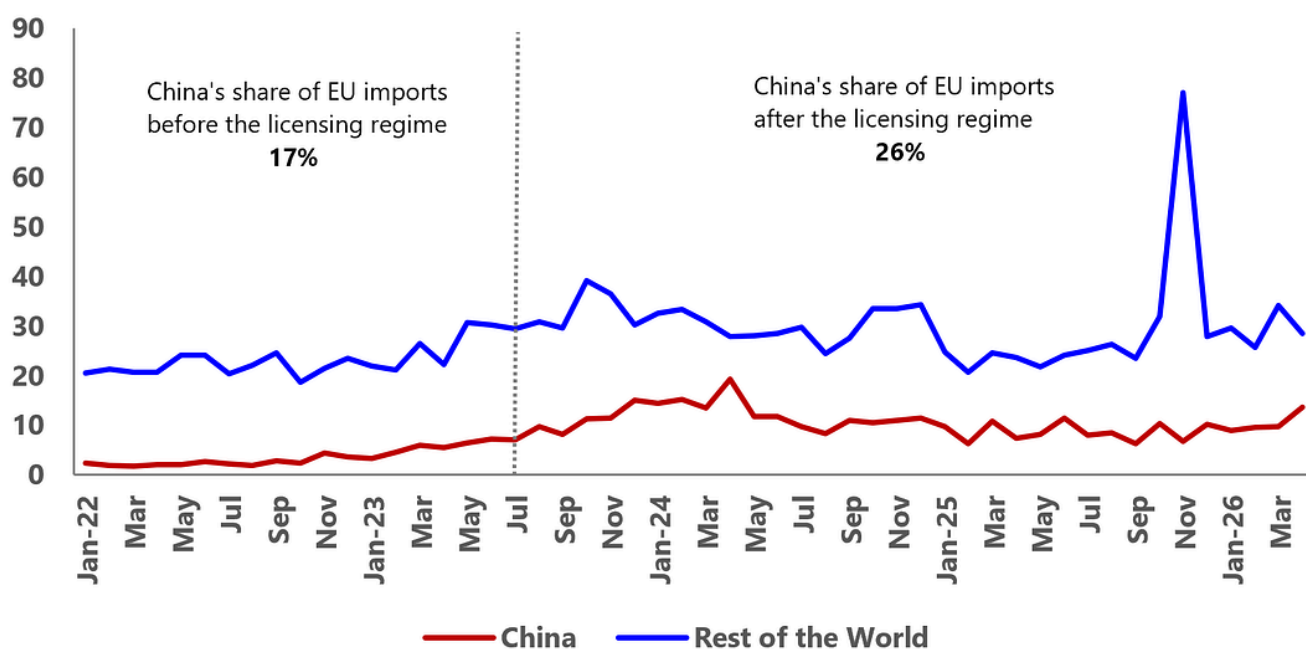
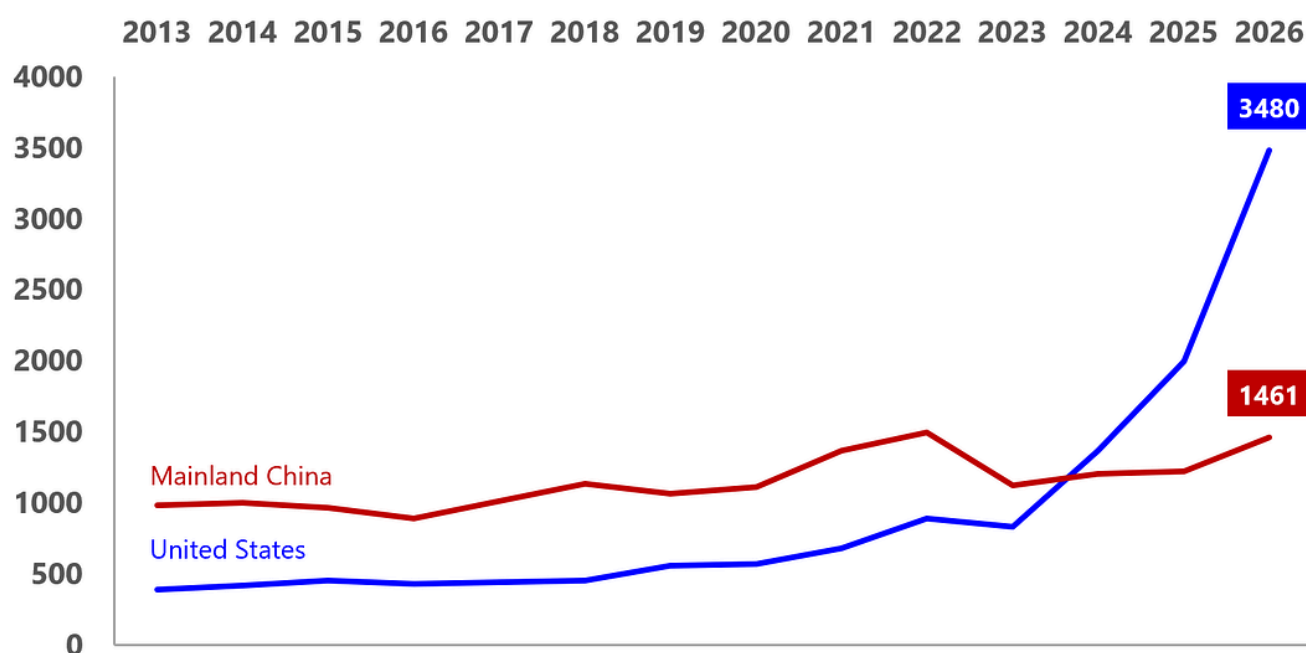


Chart 3 – Taiwan’s export map follows the chip war: US demand pulling advanced electronics westwards (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255; Taiwan exports by destination, 2018–2026).

Taiwan exports by destination, Jan-May, NT\$ bn



Source: Taiwan Customs / Ministry of Finance. Chinese mainland excludes Hong Kong.

Chart 4 – China shipped 3,500 EVs to Canada in April at ~\$29,000 FOB – on pace to fill the 49,000-unit quota quickly (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255; Chinese EV shipments to Canada under new 6.1% quota deal, 2026).

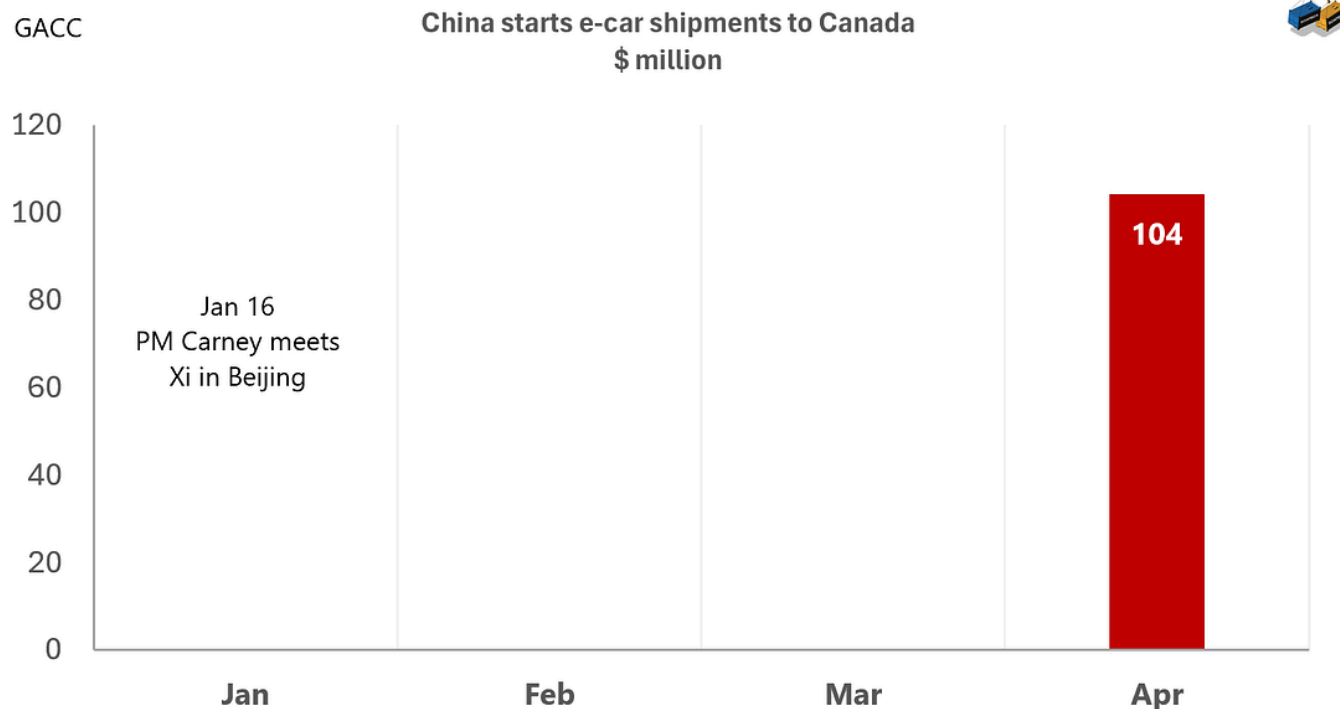
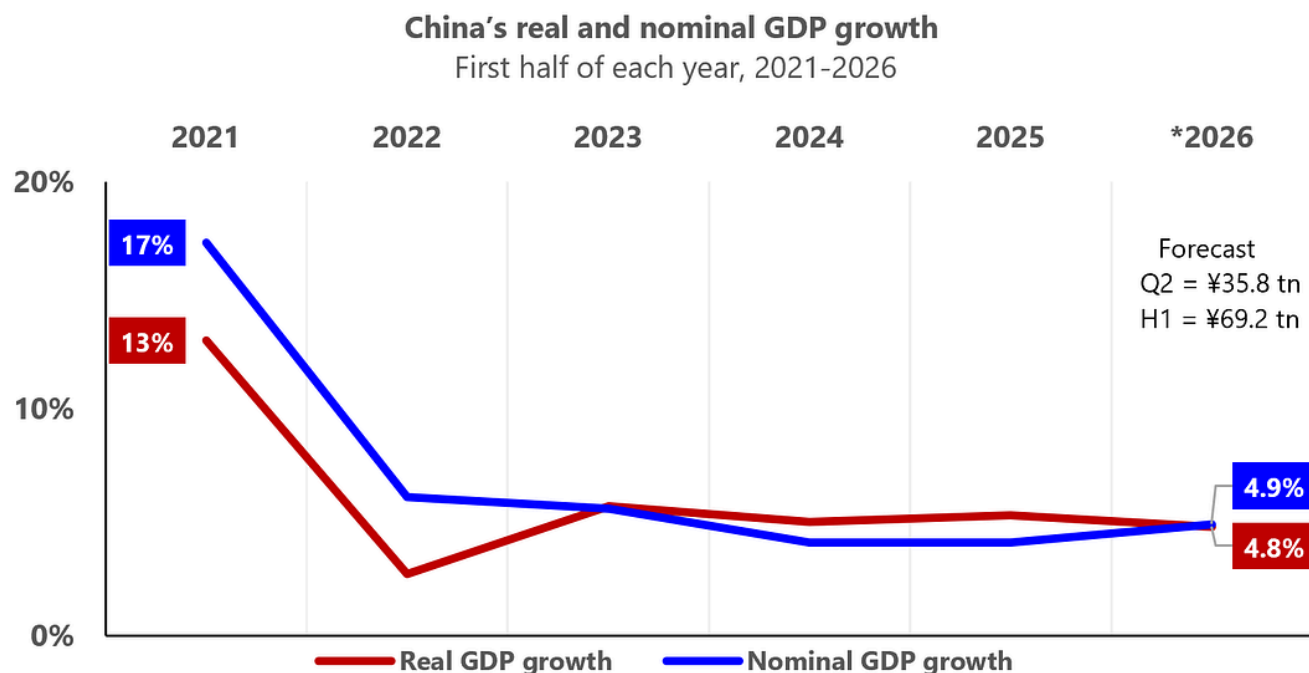


Chart 5 – China's PMI employment subindex has stayed below 50 for four straight years (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255; NBS manufacturing PMI employment subindex, monthly, 2021–2026).

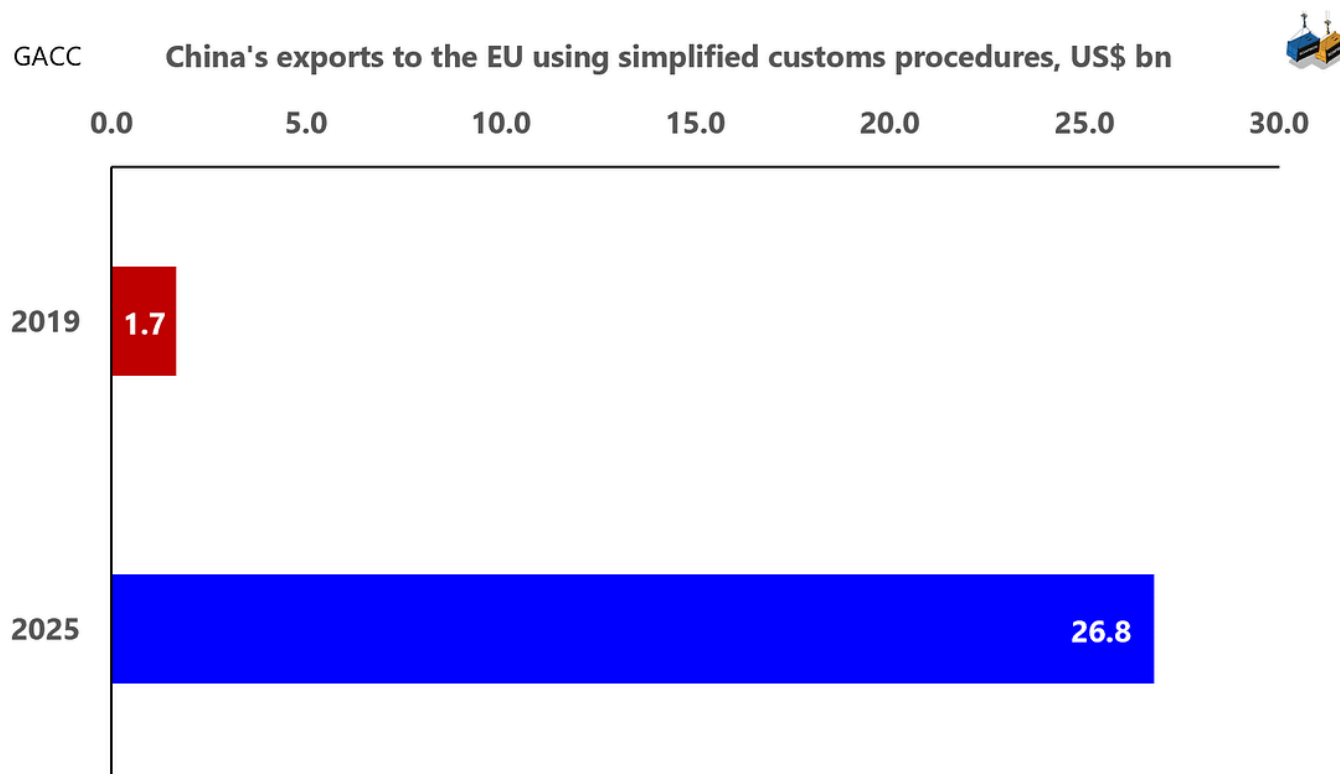


Chart 6 – China’s H1 2026 GDP deflator turns positive for the first time since H1 2022 – but only at +0.1% (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255; implied GDP deflator, half-yearly, 2015–H1 2026 forecast).



*Historical data: National Bureau of Statistics. *2026 : SOAPBOX forecast

Chart 7 – China-to-EU parcels under simplified customs procedures grew from US\$1.7bn (2019) to US\$26bn+ (2025) (Soapbox Trade × MERICS, Issue 255; Chinese exports to EU cleared via simplified procedures, USD bn, 2019–2025).



III. International

1. Domestic economic situation and policy

CAIXIN · 30 JUN 2026

In Depth: Repayment Question Looms as China Speeds Up Special Bond Issuance

- **National Audit Office found ¥132.6 billion in misused special-purpose bond funds:** A 2024 audit across nine provinces identified localities inflating projected returns, leaving funds idle, and redirecting money to cover operating expenses.
 - **Accelerated SPB issuance via streamlined approvals has not resolved repayment risks:** According to Caixin, the same mismanagement patterns flagged in prior audits persist despite the faster approval process.
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BLOOMBERG · 30 JUN 2026

China Clamps Down on Issuance of Higher-Yielding Offshore Debt

- **NDRC set informal yield caps on Chinese offshore bond underwriting:** Bankers were asked not to underwrite offshore yuan notes above 4% or dollar bonds above 5%, according to people familiar with the matter.
 - **Offshore bond maturities for Chinese firms peak at \$130 billion in 2027:** LGFVs alone hold \$117 billion outstanding, with \$71 billion due for all Chinese issuers through year-end, Bloomberg data shows.
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REUTERS · 30 JUN 2026

China central bank injects 600 billion yuan through overnight reverse repos

- **PBOC doubled overnight reverse repo injections to 600 billion yuan:** The cash addresses month-end and half-year-end funding pressures on Chinese financial institutions, Reuters reports.
 - **Rate on new overnight liquidity tool kept undisclosed by PBOC:** Goldman Sachs economist Xinquan Chen described the overnight tool as “a liquidity provision tool at this stage, similar to outright repos and MLF loans”; Reuters framed the non-disclosure as preserving the seven-day rate’s role as the primary policy signal.
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WSJ · 30 JUN 2026

China’s Manufacturing Activity Expands, Buoyed by Exports - WSJ

- **China's manufacturing PMI rose to 50.3 in June, beating forecasts:** Expansion was driven by resilient exports of AI and green products, with the new export orders subindex returning to expansionary territory at 50.1.
 - **Consumer spending fell for the first time in three years while construction remained contractionary:** The construction subindex held at 49.0 as the property slump continued, and investment contracted further, underscoring weak domestic demand.
 - **Citi expects fiscal acceleration via bond issuance and an 800 billion yuan financing tool:** Economists see limited scope for immediate large-scale stimulus but anticipate the July Politburo meeting may address consumption and household income.
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China faces policy test as subsidy pullback hits auto, appliance sales

- **Chinese domestic auto and appliance sales weakened in June:** BYD's domestic sales fell 22% year on year; Geely's overall June sales rose ~2% but domestic softness and appliance-side weakness (AC exports up sharply while domestic sales declined) point to fading subsidy support.
 - **Beijing cut its 2026 consumer subsidy budget to 250 billion yuan:** May retail sales posted the first year-on-year decline in over three years, raising pressure for second-half policy support.
 - **Goldman Sachs cut its China Q2 GDP forecast to 4.5%:** Analysts expect the July Politburo meeting to signal further support, though Pinpoint's chief economist doubts large fiscal expansion.
-

What's driving China's retailers to bet on own brands? Profit growth, price control: S&P

- **Private-label FMCG share forecast to double among top Chinese retailers:** S&P Global Ratings projects penetration rising from under 10% to 20% of sales among the top 100 chain retailers, with annual growth of 15%.
 - **Declining supplier-funded fees are pushing retailers toward higher-margin own brands:** Private labels generated 8-15% higher gross margins than branded equivalents in 2025 while priced 16% lower, according to S&P.
-

China Government Advisers Call for Fix to Two-Speed Economy

- **China's fixed-asset investment fell 4.1% in January-May 2026:** Property sector weakness and persistently low consumer confidence drove the decline while exports of AI hardware kept trade resilient, the article reports.
 - **AI concentration in high-tech sectors raises labour displacement concerns:** Automated factories increase GDP and output but reduce workforce income, making broad-based consumer recovery structurally difficult, according to advisers cited.
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China Says Tech Growth a Challenge to Predicting Energy Demand

- **China raises its five-year power-demand forecast from 570 to ~600 billion kWh added per year:** NEA planning chief Ren Yuzhi said the 15th Five-Year Plan will pencil in average annual growth exceeding what Germany produces in a year, up from the actual 570 billion kWh added over 2021–2025.
 - **Actual 2025 energy demand overshot Beijing's 2021 target by ~11%:** The plan projected 4.6 billion tons of coal equivalent for 2025 (a 14% rise from 2020); real consumption hit 5.13 billion, with fossil-fuel output up 19% over the period and another 3.4% added through May 2026.
 - **AI data centres and EV charging are the two variables Beijing cannot yet size:** Ren flagged both as the main sources of forecasting uncertainty for the 15th Five-Year energy blueprint – a rare public admission that Beijing is planning capacity blind on the fastest-growing loads.
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China's state developers power Shenzhen construction despite market woes

- **SOEs consolidate dominance over Shenzhen's prime property market:** State-owned developers including China Merchants Group, CITIC, and Poly Developments are driving construction and land purchases as cash-strapped private firms suspend projects.
 - **Shenzhen eased home-purchase restrictions to support price stabilization:** After April rule changes loosening limits for non-registered buyers, secondary market prices began stabilizing, CLSA analysts told Nikkei Asia.
 - **Private projects face steep discounts in Shenzhen's outer districts:** One developer reduced per-square-meter prices from 48,000 to 31,000 yuan before handover to boost sales, the article reports.
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The young Chinese choosing life in 'ghost cities'

- **Top-100 developer sales fell 72.7% between 2021 and 2025:** Goldman Sachs estimates 160-170 million excess housing units against just 9 million new home sales in 2023, according to the article.
 - **A former housing vice-minister cited a 15% national vacancy rate in 2022:** Rates reached 25-30% in some provinces, far above the international 5% benchmark, the article reports.
 - **China recorded 7.92 million births in 2025, the lowest since 1949:** Analysts cited by the article say structural demand collapse makes demolition of excess stock in smaller cities potentially unavoidable.
-

Chinese tech hub's shift into robotaxis leaves drivers by the wayside

- **Shenzhen rules from July 1 permit citywide robotaxi commercialisation:** The transport authority warns of a "saturated" market with 400,000 licensed drivers across 26 platforms averaging just 13 fares daily.
- **Robotaxi expansion threatens China's 320mn gig workers:** Many ride-hailing drivers previously lost factory jobs to automation; policymakers back the rollout partly to address a projected workforce decline.

2. Politics and society

A Rising Star's Abrupt Fall Shows Xi's Crackdown on Overambitious Officials - WSJ

- **Zibo party chief expelled for debt-funded prestige projects:** Jiang Duntao doubled the city's debt to 108 billion yuan on projects party investigators said exceeded Zibo's fiscal capacity.
 - **Xi Jinping orders indoctrination campaign against self-serving officials:** The party is running seminars, confession readings, and guidebook study sessions directing members to serve public welfare rather than career advancement.
 - **Fear of punishment is fuelling paralysis and fraud in officialdom:** According to the article, officials are deferring decisions, faking compliance with targets, and masking underperformance to avoid discipline under Xi's crackdown.
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Just how far are China's local officials going in falsifying performance data?

- **CCDI and a central working group publicised three falsification cases:** Xinhua reported the disclosures as part of an education campaign on the “correct view of political performance.”
 - **Nanning inflated 2024 fiscal revenue by 2.83 billion yuan via circular land deals:** Officials assigned values to state-owned plots, collected fees from SOEs, then returned the funds as compensation - cycling one plot 18 times.
 - **Gansu officials mislabelled a landscape project as flood control infrastructure:** Jiuquan district authorities fraudulently obtained 55.95 million yuan in ultra-long-term special treasury bonds by misclassifying the scheme's purpose.
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The Graduate-School Dropout Toppling China's Academic Stars - WSJ

- **Chinese video blogger's fraud allegations prompt swift university action:** Four major Chinese universities punished senior scholars within weeks of Geng Hongwei flagging errors in papers published in Nature journals.
 - **Xinhua backs Geng's campaign, citing China's scientific reputation:** Official state media warned that misconduct by leading scholars undermines the foundation of scientific integrity across Chinese society, according to a Xinhua commentary.
 - **At least six Nature-journal papers now carry active misconduct investigation notices:** The papers were flagged by Geng, whose videos have mainly targeted Springer Nature publications; none have been retracted so far.
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China covers up a plane crash in the heart of its capital

- **Small plane hit Beijing's CITIC Tower near Zhongnanhai on June 26th:** The crash days before the CCP's 105th anniversary prompted nationwide grounding of light aircraft and censorship of footage.
 - **Crash called a "massive security breach" by Beijing analysts:** Observers compared the incident to Mathias Rust's 1987 Red Square landing, noting a drone could similarly reach the capital's core.
 - **Crash expected to prompt regulatory reform of China's "low-altitude economy":** The civil aviation authority projects the drone and eVTOL sector will reach 3.5 trillion yuan (\$515bn) in turnover by 2035.
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China grounds light aircraft after Beijing tower crash

- **China quietly imposed nationwide airspace controls on recreational aviation:** Multiple operators across Hainan, Chengdu, and Beijing confirmed grounding orders from CAAC following the crash, with no public announcement and no timeline for resumption.
 - **Private flight activity in northern China halted immediately after the incident:** Flightradar24 data showed Chengdu flights continued briefly into Sunday before also stopping, while enforcement appeared inconsistent across southern cities including Shenzhen.
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China says Beijing plane crash pilot wrote about suicide

- **Pilot identified as 66-year-old surnamed Liu:** Chaoyang district authorities said he deviated from the designated route and his diary contained multiple references to “ending one’s life,” suggesting suicide.
 - **Thirteen injured in the crash, none fatally:** The aircraft was an Aurora SA60L, a single-engine two-seat propeller plane manufactured by a Chinese company, according to the official WeChat statement.
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Why a light plane crash in Beijing created a security dilemma for authorities

- **Flight schools across China grounded after Beijing skyscraper crash:** Authorities ordered a nationwide training halt pending CAAC reinspection, after a light aircraft struck Citic Tower, killing the pilot and injuring 13.
 - **Security expert cites urban shoot-down dilemma exposed by the crash:** A government think tank analyst told SCMP that destroying a civilian aircraft over a crowded area risked causing panic and ground casualties, leaving authorities no viable interception option.
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China’s Politburo warns of extreme weather, urges preparations for floods and droughts

- **Ministry of Water Resources already running an emergency response across five provinces:** Anhui, Jiangxi, Hubei, Hunan and Guizhou were placed under a joint flood response on 18 June, framing the 30 June Politburo session as ratification of an ongoing crisis, not a forward-looking warning.
 - **Politburo ordered a "rapid-response overhaul" targeting river- and lake-flood discharge corridors:** The meeting told local governments to clear obstructions in flood-discharge spaces, harden agricultural infrastructure, and push rescue equipment and personnel down to the grassroots – a shift from prevention rhetoric to enforcement of existing hydraulic rules.
 - **"Drought–flood abrupt alternation" named as this year's specific threat:** Officials singled out simultaneous drought and flood conditions in the same regions, calling for unified water-source dispatching – language that acknowledges the 2022 Yangtze-basin pattern is now the planning baseline.
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What a seating chart might reveal about the future of China’s military leadership

- **Two lieutenant generals appeared for the first time in top PLA leadership seating at a high-profile CCP anniversary gala:** Zhang Shuguang and Wang Gang were seated alongside Defence Minister Dong Jun and a theatre command chief, signalling their likely elevation.
 - **PLA anti-corruption purges have created leadership vacancies the new seating arrangement appears to address:** The article reports the pair’s prominent positioning reflects the ongoing reshaping of military leadership following the anti-graft campaign.
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China sells a softer image of Xinjiang, one tourist at a time

- **Altay tourism boom follows heavy state infrastructure investment:** A new 209-kilometer highway and airline routes are part of Beijing's push to integrate Xinjiang economically and culturally.
 - **Xinjiang tourism experience is carefully controlled, researcher says:** State media promotes a "real Xinjiang" counter-narrative to Western human rights accounts, according to a researcher cited in the article.
 - **New ethnic unity law authorizes action against overseas critics:** The law, effective July 1, allows Beijing to target people abroad who challenge its minority assimilation policies, critics say.
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The world has failed the Uyghurs

- **Trump's May 2026 Beijing visit made no public mention of Xinjiang:** Author Tahir Imin notes that despite the first Trump administration's own genocide designation, "there is no indication that this human rights catastrophe even came up" in the Xi meetings – marking, in his reading, the end of Xinjiang as a US-China agenda item.
 - **The argument pivots from "stop China" to "fund diaspora survival":** Imin calls on Western governments to redirect support toward diaspora-run cultural and news projects (he cites his own Uyghur Post) because sanctions and genocide declarations have been "shrugged off" by Beijing without changing conditions inside Xinjiang.
 - **Cyberattacks and intimidation now the main pressure on overseas Uyghurs:** Imin reports sustained attacks on Uyghur-run websites and harassment of activists abroad, framing transnational repression – not the camps – as the operational front line in 2026.
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What Beijing hopes to achieve with new ethnic unity law that targets people overseas

- **New ethnic unity law applies to overseas actors from next month:** China's ethnic unity legislation holds overseas individuals and organisations liable under Article 63 for undermining ethnic unity.
 - **Article 63 seen as deterrent rather than practically enforceable tool:** Beijing is signalling that ethnic separatism will no longer be treated as a purely domestic matter, analysts say.
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Chinese Dissident Who Fled by Sea to South Korea Lands in Canada - The New York Times

- **Dong Guangping arrived in Canada after decade-long escape attempt:** The 68-year-old Chinese dissident completed a 36-hour solo inflatable boat crossing from Weihai, China, before South Korean authorities released him.
 - **South Korean judge denied arrest warrant, enabling Dong's departure:** After legal access was granted at a coast guard station, a court rejected detention and authorities issued an exit permit allowing him to fly to Toronto.
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How Hong Kong quietly 'rehabilitates' former protesters

- **Hong Kong authorities run "rehabilitation" scheme for uncharged 2019 protesters:** A government program invites some of the roughly 7,000 uncharged detainees to sign loyalty pledges and attend sessions designed to induce remorse, the article reports.
- **Security secretary described program as alternative to prosecution:** Chris Tang said participants are given a chance to “start afresh within the bounds of the law,” with no attendees re-arrested since, according to local media reports.
- **1,776 jailed protesters enrolled in parallel prison rehabilitation program:** The Correctional Services Department’s Project PATH focuses on national identity, Chinese history, and psychological reconstruction, the department confirmed.

3. Geoeconomics: trade, tech, finance, investment

PLA MoD English release 16472056

- **PLA Navy test-launched a submarine-based strategic missile into the Pacific:** A nuclear submarine fired a dummy-warhead missile at 12:01 p.m. on 6 July, landing within designated waters, Xinhua reported.
 - **China described the launch as routine annual training, conducted with prior notification:** The PLA Navy said the test complies with international law and is not directed at any specific country.
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China's rare-earth industry has critical weakness, researchers warn

- **Japan and US lead rare earth technology patents, study finds:** Chinese researchers conclude the US holds advantages across catalytic, luminescent, and polishing functional materials, areas where China trails significantly.
 - **Most Chinese rare earth research fails to generate high-value patents:** Authors found weak university-industry coordination and incentives favouring publications over patent development leave many advances at laboratory stage.
-

America's third century will be shared with China

- **Author argues China's scale already surpasses the US:** China’s economy is 30% larger by purchasing power, with twice the manufacturing capacity and the world’s largest navy.
 - **Doshi proposes managed competition and allied scale as twin pillars:** Both allow the US to set coexistence terms rather than pursue containment or accommodation, the author argues.
 - **Proposed allied policies include shared tariffs and cross-investment:** Japanese and Korean help rebuilding US shipyards, Taiwanese fabs on American soil, and joint rare-earth refining would break Chinese monopolies.
-

Has China obtained the world's most important machine?

- **US commerce secretary Lutnick alleges an ASML EUV machine reached China:** ASML denies this, stating it tracks all 340 units produced and none is located in China.
 - **SMIC and Huawei used DUV multi-patterning to produce sub-7nm chips:** The technique had previously required EUV machines; some American experts warn China could scale this approach for AI chip production.
 - **The MATCH Act would restrict DUV servicing and parts for machines already in China:** The Dutch government objects to its extraterritorial scope, its trade minister told The Economist on July 2nd.
-

China, Russia to hold Joint Sea-2026 naval exercise + Pacific patrol

- **China and Russia announced "Joint Sea-2026" naval drills near Qingdao:** China's Ministry of National Defense said the exercise will take place this month in waters and airspace near the Shandong Province port city.
- **Post-exercise Pacific patrol planned for forces from both sides:** Following the drills, selected naval units will conduct a joint maritime patrol in unspecified areas of the Pacific Ocean, according to the ministry.

3a. Geoeconomics – tech & innovation

China Has Matched Anthropic in Cybersecurity, Resetting AI Race

- **Zhipu's open-weight GLM-5.2 matched US models in cybersecurity bug-finding:** Semgrep benchmarks found the Chinese model outperformed Anthropic's Opus 4.8 in some tests; with prompting, it can match Mythos 5.
 - **US access curbs on Fable 5 are accelerating Chinese model adoption:** Critics warn that restricting US models while continuing chip sales to China hands Beijing a competitive advantage.
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Anthropic moves to close loopholes that allow Chinese access to Claude

- **Ant Financial and ByteDance accessed Claude via overseas workarounds:** Ant routed access through a Singapore subsidiary's intranet; ByteDance reimbursed engineers' personal VPN subscriptions, according to five employees and the FT.
 - **Microsoft Azure functioned as a conduit for mainland Chinese API access:** Companies with Singapore-incorporated entities used Microsoft's cloud to give China-based engineers access to Claude through internal corporate networks.
 - **Anthropic says it alone bans PRC-controlled firms, including foreign subsidiaries:** The company said it uses continuously evolving detection systems to identify and ban violating accounts, citing timezone checks via Claude Code as one method.
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A new, inexpensive Chinese AI model is catching up with Anthropic, OpenAI on their home turf

- **GLM-5.2 holds fifth place on Artificial Analysis's LLM intelligence leaderboard:** Z.ai's model costs one-sixth of US frontier alternatives and ranks above Anthropic's offerings on the OpenRouter developer platform.
 - **Chinese LLM global share rose to 13% in two months:** A RAND study of 135-country web traffic data found the gain followed DeepSeek's R1 launch, concentrated in developing countries.
 - **Western enterprise adoption of Chinese AI constrained by data security:** Analysts say regulated industries in banking and cybersecurity may reject Chinese models regardless of technical performance or price.
-

China's plan to save jobs from A.I.

- **Hangzhou court ruled in April that an AI-driven dismissal was illegal:** The ruling cautioned employers that technological upgrading must take into account the protection of workers' legitimate rights and interests.
 - **China's current five-year plan explicitly commits to addressing AI's employment impact:** Beijing pairs its AI superpower ambitions with state pressure on firms to retain displaced workers, backed by court enforcement.
 - **The article contrasts state-driven Chinese and company-led US AI visions:** China embeds AI across industries to achieve government goals including stability, while US policy largely defers to Silicon Valley's superintelligence push, the article argues.
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八部门重磅发布！事关AI、算力、工业互联网

- **MIIT-led directive folds AI compute into industrial internet planning rather than announcing new funds:** Intelligent and supercomputing facilities are to be co-planned and co-built with industrial networks, with explicit backing for industry-domain large models – a coordination reframe, not a disclosed budget increase.
 - **2030 headline targets largely restate existing 5G and platform goals:** The plan calls for core industry value-added above 2.5 trillion yuan, 50,000 industrial 5G private networks, roughly five internationally influential platforms and coverage of all 207 industrial sub-categories.
 - **Foreign investment invitation is routed through BRI and BRICS:** Authorities are told to implement the encouraged foreign investment catalogue and to deepen international cooperation via Belt and Road and BRICS mechanisms.
 - **New directive integrates AI computing with industrial internet infrastructure buildout:** Intelligent and supercomputing facilities are to be co-planned and co-built with industrial networks to support large model training and industrial metaverse scenarios.
 - **Foreign firms invited to join industrial internet expansion:** The directive instructs authorities to implement the encouraged foreign investment catalogue and deepen international cooperation via BRI and BRICS mechanisms.
-

Faster AI, lower costs: DSpark eases inference bottlenecks and chip strain, says DeepSeek

- **DSpark framework increases DeepSeek V4 inference speed by 85%:** The speculative decoding system allows a single GPU to handle around 185 user queries instead of 100, reducing computing resource requirements.
 - **DSpark aims to ease reliance on advanced AI chip infrastructure:** The open-source framework, developed with Peking University, was tested on Google's Gemma and Alibaba's Qwen, suggesting broad applicability across models.
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Meituan claims China's biggest AI model trained on local chips

- **Meituan claims first trillion-parameter model trained fully on domestic chips:** LongCat-2.0, at 1.6 trillion parameters, completed both pre-training and inference on a 50,000-card Huawei ASIC cluster, the company said.
 - **Domestic hardware gaps remain significant despite the milestone:** Meituan acknowledged its accelerators carry far less memory per device than Nvidia's banned H800, and the supporting software ecosystem is still less developed.
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China's Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo cut 2026 smartphone targets again: sources

- **Xiaomi slashed its 2026 shipment forecast 30% to 95 million:** Oppo and Vivo also revised below 90 million units amid component shortages and surging costs, Nikkei Asia sources said.
 - **AI infrastructure demand is diverting LPDDR chips from smartphone makers:** Low-power DRAM, previously used mainly in mobile devices, is increasingly allocated to AI servers such as Nvidia's Vera CPU trays.
 - **Counterpoint Research forecasts a record 14% global smartphone market decline:** The Android camp - to which all four Chinese brands belong - is projected to fall by as much as 21%.
-

In Profile: The Man Behind China's Leading Memory Chipmaker

- **China's securities regulator approved CXMT's IPO registration on June 12:** The listing would be the largest ever on Shanghai's STAR Market, with market value expectations reaching into the trillions of yuan.
 - **Memory chip shortage fuels CXMT financial turnaround and investor expectations:** Many investors see the DRAM producer as central to the current domestic technology stock bull run, the article reports.
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Supermicro Taiwan offices raided in chip smuggling probe

- **Taiwan prosecutors raided Supermicro's office over alleged illegal server exports:** The Keelung District Prosecutors Office also searched local distributor Albatron Technology, with Supermicro confirming co-operation with Taiwanese authorities.
 - **US prosecutors charged Supermicro's co-founder with smuggling \$2.5bn of Nvidia AI servers to China:** Wally Liaw resigned from the board after the March indictment; he and co-defendant Willy Sun have pleaded not guilty.
 - **Nvidia chip black market prices in China have doubled this year:** The FT reported the increase as US authorities intensify enforcement of export controls banning advanced AI chip sales to China.
-

As battery retirement wave approaches, China moves to clean up recycling

- **MIIT and four agencies launched a nationwide battery recycling crackdown:** New rules simultaneously require EV makers and battery manufacturers to collect end-of-life power cells, the article reports.
 - **Retired power battery volumes grew over 30% in 2025 to 400,000 tons:** Frost & Sullivan projects volumes will reach 3.5 million tons by 2030 - a market worth over 100 billion yuan (\$14.8 billion).
 - **Collapsed lithium prices have left the recycling sector broadly unprofitable:** Under 30% of retired batteries reach formal channels, as unlicensed operators undercut compliant firms, Caixin reports.
-

China's newest IP office to cut hi-tech patent approval times 'by 70%'

- **Xiongan gets a national IP centre as the Jing-Jin-Ji hub for hi-tech patents:** The site is pitched as anchoring coordinated innovation across Beijing, Tianjin and Hebei rather than concentrating examination in Beijing.
 - **The 70% cut compresses approvals from 15 months to about three – mechanism unspecified:** Xiongan authorities cite expedited examination and one-stop IP services without detailing whether the speed-up comes from extra examiners or procedural reform.
 - **Scope is narrowed to next-generation IT and new materials as US tech rivalry deepens:** Officials frame the centre as helping firms secure protection and commercialise faster in the two sectors where China is pushing hardest to close gaps.
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China cools on overseas publication of scientific research

- **Beijing mulling national security criteria in academic evaluation framework:** Several ministries are developing rules to embed security considerations in science evaluation and reduce reliance on SCI journal metrics for academic promotion.
 - **Security ministry accused researcher of leaking data via journal submissions:** The Ministry of State Security said a researcher included core equipment structures and key technical parameters in submissions to international journals and academic conferences.
 - **International publishers noting fewer Chinese submissions since early this year:** One executive at an international publisher reported fewer submissions from China since early 2025; a materials-science researcher said security reviews had become too unclear to navigate.
-

China leads in GPS-style, reconnaissance and anti-satellite abilities, US report says

- **ITIF ranks China ahead in remote sensing and counterspace:** China's satellite imaging ecosystem and anti-satellite investments have given Beijing an edge over the US in both sectors, the report finds.
 - **US leads decisively in LEO broadband and reusable rockets:** SpaceX's Starlink and Falcon 9 outpace Chinese rivals, which the report identifies as Beijing's most significant commercial space weakness.
 - **ITIF warns China may overtake the US in space:** Without decisive action, Beijing could claim the global top spot as the projected \$1 trillion space economy expands, the foundation argues.
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Will China build an electric rocket launch pad on the roof of the world?

- **Concept cleared a first ground test in March 2026 but remains early research:** A Beijing space scientist told SCMP the electromagnetic launch approach is engineering-feasible while flagging many implementation difficulties ahead.
 - **Cost pitch rests on Ma Weiming's 2019 patent claiming an order-of-magnitude launch-cost cut:** Superconducting maglev acceleration to supersonic speed before ignition would remove much of the first-stage propulsion burden, the CASIC-linked Ziyang institute argues.
 - **The Tibetan Plateau site is pitched as a direct shot at SpaceX's reusable-rocket lead:** Thin air at altitude aids electromagnetic acceleration, and the article frames the approach as one that could make chemical rockets obsolete after SpaceX's record IPO.
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Why Malaysia's tourism boom lives and dies on a Chinese app

- **RedNote is now the default itinerary tool for Chinese travellers – 600 million daily searches, 130 million monthly outbound users:** Whether a Kuala Lumpur venue fills or empties turns on algorithmic visibility rather than intrinsic appeal, the article argues.
 - **Malaysia is unusually exposed because it fits the feed – mosques, Mandarin speakers, durian, photogenic food:** Cultural proximity makes it “ideal fodder” for a platform that “can dismantle reputations as fast as it builds them”.
 - **Paid boosts and unlicensed operators sit outside Malaysian regulatory reach:** 35 yuan buys 2,000 undisclosed placements and scam packages sold via the app prompted a warning from the travel agents association – but enforcement rests with a Chinese platform, not Kuala Lumpur.
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Tencent Trials TenPayGo Pay App as Foreign Visits to China Rise

- **TenPayGo lets overseas visitors spend directly at Weixin Pay's tens of millions of merchants:** Tencent designed it as a one-stop app bundling transport, dining and shopping for non-Chinese users – Alipay's rival Tour Pass reaches the same merchants only via a prepaid wallet co-issued with Bank of Shanghai.
- **The rollout is limited internal testing, not a public launch:** PaymentsJournal reports the app has not yet been released, leaving Alipay's Tour Pass – whose 2026 upgrade raised the single top-up cap to 2,000 yuan and daily spend to 6,000 yuan – ahead on availability.
- **The trial sits within Tencent's wider cross-border payments push:** Tencent recently linked WeChat Pay with Mastercard Move for outbound remittances, and PaymentsJournal frames TenPayGo as the inbound-side counterpart aimed at foreign-card friction.

3b. Geoeconomics – trade, finance & industrial policy

China Proposes Overhaul of Procurement, Bidding Laws to Aid Foreign Firms

- **China submitted draft revisions to procurement and bidding laws:** The proposals, open for public consultation, ban buyers from imposing discriminatory conditions on suppliers based on ownership type, organizational structure, or scale.
 - **Overhaul targets opaque processes that disadvantaged foreign and private firms:** Draft revisions to the decades-old frameworks were submitted to the top legislature in late June, according to Caixin.
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Europeans Snap Up Chinese AC as Record Heat Scorches the Continent

- **Chinese portable AC exports to Western Europe surged over 70% year-on-year in January-May:** ChinaIOL data attribute the spike to a heat wave that pushed temperatures near 40°C and killed more than 200 people in Spain, with Midea's PortaSplit unit designed by a European team to fit local window formats.
 - **Portable units bypass Europe's split-AC regulatory barriers:** Strict building rules and high installation costs kept household AC penetration at roughly 20% in 2025 (IEA) – a structural gap Chinese portable brands can fill without local partners or permits.
 - **Saxo Bank flags a supply-chain risk if demand normalizes:** The bank warned the portable-AC chain could strain after the heat wave, though repeated summers may turn the units from luxury to standard household equipment across the region.
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China auto exports expected to near 10 million in 2026 amid overseas push

- **Chinese auto exports forecast to near 10 million units in 2026:** AlixPartners projects a 41% jump from 7.1 million vehicles exported in 2025, per its annual global automotive market outlook released June 30.
 - **Chinese automakers shifting from exports toward building local overseas production capacity:** Slowing domestic market growth is driving firms to establish local manufacturing bases and deeper regional footprints abroad, the article reports.
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BYD spots North America foothold amid US-Canada tariff discord

- **Canada's tariff break opened a BYD entry point:** Ottawa's Carney-Xi deal (January 2026) set a 49,000-unit import quota at 6.1% duty; the quota year began 1 March, with first Tesla-Shanghai and Lotus imports arriving in May.
 - **OECD flags Chinese EV subsidies at 3-8× peers:** An OECD report cited by Nikkei found Chinese producer subsidies run several times higher than in other major economies, with SOE contracts adding further cost advantages in steel, electricity, and logistics.
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How China wriggled free when Trump closed a tariff loophole

- **Temu and Shein shifted to US warehouse distribution after de minimis abolition:** Chinese logistics firms simultaneously entered US last-mile delivery, competing directly with American service companies, according to FT reporting.
 - **Under-declared Chinese shipments have widened the US-China bilateral trade data gap:** A White House customs enforcement order signed June 2026 gives CBP up to 180 days to implement new importer-of-record requirements.
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China restricts exports to Mitsubishi, Hitachi, Komatsu units

- **China blacklisted 20 Japanese defense-linked firms for dual-use exports:** Units of Mitsubishi Electric and MHI head the list; 20 more - including Hitachi and Komatsu subsidiaries and drone makers ACSL and Terra Drones - face mandatory individual licensing.
- **Beijing cited Japan's April defense export liberalization as the trigger:** China's Foreign Ministry called the measures "fully justified," alleging Tokyo is accelerating a "new form of militarism" after it eased rules on defense equipment exports and signed a frigate contract with Australia.

China targets more Japanese companies with export controls

- **Mitsubishi Electric and MHI subsidiaries added to China's dual-use export ban:** The expanded blacklist also covers Japan's National Institute for Defense Studies and the Naval and Ground Systems Research Centers; Chinese exporters may not ship dual-use items to listed entities, and re-export of Chinese-origin goods to them is prohibited.
- **A parallel watch list of 20 more entities triggers case-by-case licensing:** Mitsui E&S, drone maker Terra Drone, and Hitachi and Komatsu subsidiaries now require individual MOFCOM review – Beijing cites "national security and nonproliferation" and accuses Tokyo of "new militarism" after April's defense-export liberalization.
- **EU Chamber of Commerce found China nearly tripled its export-control use over five years:** The April report noted Beijing deliberately targets trade chokepoints both in response to and independently of Western measures – the Japan escalation follows January's rare-earth and magnet ban tied to Tokyo's defense-export easing.

Apple seeks to buy memory chips from blacklisted Chinese company

- **Apple lobbying for clearance to source chips from CXMT:** The FT reports Apple has targeted the Commerce Department and White House officials seeking approval to buy from the Pentagon-blacklisted Chinese DRAM maker.
- **White House halted planned CXMT Entity List designation:** Commerce prepared export controls against CXMT but was told to stand down during US-China trade truce negotiations, per the FT.
- **Congressional leaders oppose any Apple deal with CXMT:** House China committee chair Moolenaar called such a partnership a "grave mistake" that would deepen US technology dependence on Beijing.

Booming AI chip trade seals Hong Kong's role as gateway to China

- **Hong Kong handled 52% of China's chip imports in early 2026:** The city re-exported \$124 billion in semiconductors to the mainland in January-May, according to Hong Kong customs data.
- **HSBC estimates AI-driven intra-Asian trade doubled to \$2 trillion:** Hong Kong exported \$159 billion of AI-related goods last year, with the Hong Kong Trade Development Council projecting over 20% export growth in 2026.
- **Hong Kong now sources most US-origin chips from third countries:** Following Washington's removal of special customs privileges, Chief Executive John Lee led diversification missions to the Middle East and Southeast Asia.

WSJ · 4 JUL 2026

Taiwan Steps Up Probe into AI Hardware Smuggling

- **Keelung prosecutors summoned six individuals on document forgery charges:** The case stems from a May investigation into an alleged scheme to export Nvidia-equipped Super Micro AI servers to China.
 - **Searches extended to Chief Telecom and Albatron Technology:** Both the data-centre provider and Super Micro distributor said they are cooperating and the probe will not materially affect their operations.
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SCMP · 3 JUL 2026

Potential US ban on Chinese inverters would harm local power industry, firms warn

- **US plan to ban foreign inverters would take years to replace Chinese supply:** Sungrow warned it took China 20 years to build its inverter industrial chain and the US would need at least five years to develop local alternatives.
 - **Chinese firms hold six of the top ten global inverter supplier rankings:** Sungrow and Huawei are the world's two largest suppliers, according to a Wood Mackenzie report cited by SCMP.
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BLOOMBERG · 30 JUN 2026

China Seen Lifting Some Fuel Export Curbs on Ample Supplies

- **Sinopec and CNPC cleared to resume diesel and gasoline exports to a wider destination list:** Beijing is rolling back the March halt imposed when Strait of Hormuz disruption tightened crude flows, extending permitted destinations well beyond the handful of "oil-starved neighbors" earlier exempted.
 - **State-refiner stockpiles hit multi-year highs on weak domestic demand:** OilChem reports gasoline stocks at their highest since 2025 and diesel since 2024, after wartime price spikes suppressed Chinese consumption and left refiners with barrels they cannot place at home.
 - **Restart will pressure Asian refining margins:** China is Asia's third-largest fuel exporter after South Korea and Singapore; returning Chinese cargoes will erode the elevated crack spreads Korean and Singaporean refiners captured while Chinese supply was frozen.
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NYT · 29 JUN 2026

China Emerges as a Relative Winner From Strait of Hormuz Crisis - The New York Times

- **Asia Group finds China insulated from Hormuz energy shock:** Beijing drew on oil reserves and refinery export quotas to protect domestic manufacturers from the price spikes hitting regional rivals, the firm reports.
 - **Energy disruptions undercut Southeast Asia's manufacturing competitiveness versus China:** Higher fuel and chemical costs are slowing factory relocation out of China into regional alternatives, according to Asia Group analysts.
 - **China's clean energy exports surged as Asia sought supply alternatives:** Regional demand for Chinese solar panels, battery storage, and EVs rose sharply amid the crisis, the report states.
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China-Europe Train Trips Skirting Russia Surge Nearly 80%

- **China-Europe southern corridor freight trips surged nearly 80% in 2026:** Caixin attributes the increase to Ukraine war-driven avoidance of Russian routes and Hormuz shipping disruptions pushing cargo overland.
 - **Chinese state-owned railways are scaling up overseas logistics investment:** Operators are expanding infrastructure to support the southern corridor and strengthen broader cross-border freight networks, according to Caixin.
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China solar panel material JV remains dormant months after launch

- **China's polysilicon consolidation JV is dormant six months after launch:** Guanghe Qiancheng, formed by ten Chinese companies in December to restructure overcapacity, has shown no sign of business activity, Nikkei reports.
 - **SAMR warned JV investors against coordinating production capacity or sales prices:** China's antitrust regulator summoned the participating companies in January; MIIT Minister Li Lecheng separately cited monopolization risks at a late-January industry meeting.
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Energy storage sector tested as China sets 60-day payment cap in anti-involution campaign

- **China caps battery payment terms at 60 days to curb price disorder:** Two industry alliances issued rules covering EV and energy storage batteries as part of the national anti-involution strategy.
 - **Eleven firms including CATL and BYD commit to new payment standards:** Fitch Ratings warns the rules may modestly pressure downstream players' cash flexibility but expects no immediate financial impact.
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Hong Kong's wealth crown reveals China's capital control dilemma

- **Hong Kong overtook Switzerland as the world's top cross-border wealth hub:** BCG's May 2026 study put HK-managed foreign assets at USD 2.95 trillion vs Switzerland's USD 2.946 trillion, up 10.7% year-on-year – with mainland Chinese clients supplying over 60% of the book.
 - **The dilemma – HK's rise is powered by exactly the flows Beijing wants to stop:** CSRC fined Tiger Brokers, Futu and Longbridge over USD 330 million for giving mainlanders unauthorized access to overseas stocks, its toughest cross-border enforcement yet; scrutiny is spreading into HK banking, insurance, and real estate.
 - **Beijing is signalling capital control now outranks HK's financial competitiveness:** Giovannini (ICBC) argues that tightening enforcement against mainlanders using HK brokerages to buy foreign assets undermines the same inflows underpinning HK's hub status – a tradeoff Beijing had so far avoided naming.
 - **Roughly 60% of Hong Kong's managed assets originate from mainland China:** The author argues restricting those flows risks undermining Hong Kong's recent resurgence as a global financial hub.
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When and how will China ease capital controls?

- **CSRC fined three Hong Kong brokerages over \$330 million:** Tiger Brokers, Futu Securities, and Longbridge were penalized for giving mainland investors unauthorized access to overseas stocks; investors themselves face no penalties.
- **The author argues capital controls serve three distinct purposes:** preventing yuan volatility from hot money, protecting retail investors from Ponzi schemes, and blocking predatory currency speculation.
- **Author recommends Tobin tax as path toward capital account opening:** A 1% conversion levy would cost 24% annually for monthly holdings but just 0.4% for five-year investments.

4. Foreign policy and 'Global China'

China Increases Military and Economic Pressure on Japan - The New York Times

- **Takaichi's Taiwan defense comment triggered China's pressure campaign:** Analysts describe the scale and diversity of Beijing's measures - spanning trade, military, and academic domains - as the worst in many years.
 - **Rare earth controls effectively zero out exports to blacklisted firms:** Military-use review requirements will delay approvals indefinitely, according to a senior fellow at the Dai-ichi Life Research Institute.
 - **Joint China-Russia bomber patrol near Japan on Saturday:** Fifteen aircraft prompted Tokyo to scramble fighters; China's coast guard also separately patrolled disputed waters east of Taiwan.
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China Adds More Japanese Entities to Export Control List

- **China blacklisted 20 Japanese defence-linked entities from receiving dual-use exports:** The Commerce Ministry added firms including Mitsubishi Heavy Industries units and the National Institute for Defense Studies to its export control list.
 - **A further 20 Japanese companies placed on a scrutiny watchlist:** Firms in drone and nuclear fuel sectors now face enhanced review for potential military end-use without a full export ban.
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China finds audience for talk of Japan 'militarism' beyond Russia, North Korea

- **Anti-militarism language embedded in joint statements with Pakistan, Bangladesh, Myanmar:** China secured condemnations of “fascism and militarism” in post-summit communiques with three Asian partners in May-June, without explicitly naming Japan.
 - **Russia-China May summit statement named Japan directly:** The communique called Japan’s “remilitarization” a “serious threat to regional peace and stability” and demanded Tokyo reject “new militarism.”
 - **Mongolia condemned militarism days after agreeing to deepen Japan ties:** A June Wang Yi communique included anti-militarism language less than a week after Mongolian and Japanese foreign ministers agreed to strengthen their strategic partnership.
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China's influence pipeline is already active in Japan's information space

- **Xinhua commentary repackaged as neutral news in Japan:** Docomo, AU, and regional broadcaster Chiba TV republished the piece within an hour, with the “commentary” label stripped, according to the author.
 - **TikTok reaches 42 million monthly users in Japan:** The platform, tied to China’s Cyberspace Administration, reaches 55% of Japanese teenagers and 33.2% of all age groups, per a 2025 government survey.
 - **Operation targets Japan's near-even split on Article 9:** With 50% for and 48% against constitutional revision, the author argues Beijing needs only a marginal shift to obstruct security normalization.
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Japan USB drive viruses echo earlier plot with links to Chinese military

- **PLA Unit 61419 linked to 2016-17 attacks on ~200 Japanese organisations:** Tokyo police traced the operation’s handler to the Qingdao unit, which allegedly directed the “Tick” cyberespionage group.
 - **Student directed via app to procure USB drives for Chinese handler:** He bought devices on Amazon and mailed them to a Qingdao address believed linked to PLA Unit 61419.
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Mainland justifies coast guard patrols near Taiwan

- **TAO spokeswoman invokes EEZ rights to justify coast guard patrols:** Zhu Fenglian cited China’s exclusive economic zone east of Taiwan as the legal basis for coast guard operations in the area.
 - **DPP accused of using maritime dispute to promote independence:** Zhu said Taiwan’s ruling party exploited the coast guard issue to spread separatist rhetoric, calling DPP authorities accomplices of external forces.
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Chinese Military Teases First Look of Sixth-Gen Jet in Video

- **PLA promotional video shows apparent first public glimpse of J-36 fighter:** A Y-20 anniversary video released 28 June 2026 briefly captured what defence analysts identify as China's tailless diamond-wing sixth-generation prototype.
 - **China's Defence Ministry has not confirmed the aircraft's identity:** The J-36 had previously appeared only in unverified social media footage, with a suspected test flight filmed in late 2025.
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Wang Yi warns Marco Rubio to approach Taiwan affairs with 'utmost caution'

- **First cabinet-level US-China contact since Trump's mid-May Beijing summit:** Xinhua labelled the 1 July call "positive and constructive" – signalling Beijing wants to preserve the summit-era framework and treat further US moves as breaches of it, not renegotiate the terms.
 - **Wang framed Taiwan as the single issue that could unwind that framework:** He told Rubio to act with "extra prudence" on Taiwan and paired it with a call to "manage various risks and potential dangers," making Taiwan the named destabiliser of the stability track both sides had agreed to defend.
-

Chinese exile Miles Guo given 30 years in prison for \$550mn fraud

- **Miles Guo receives 30-year sentence and \$889mn forfeiture:** Manhattan judge Analisa Torres cited exploitation of what she called a "philanthropic purpose", intimidation of critics, and refusal to accept responsibility.
 - **Defence argued sentence validates CCP campaign against Guo:** His attorneys claimed the ruling would chill dissident activity; prosecutors called him a con artist certain to reoffend if freed.
-

Former Chinese Billionaire and Bannon Associate Is Sentenced for Fraud - The New York Times

- **US court sentenced Chinese dissident Guo Wengui to 30 years:** Manhattan federal judge Torres ruled he had "preyed on people seeking democracy in China," defrauding investors of hundreds of millions of dollars.
 - **235 victims submitted statements, many reporting lost life savings:** Prosecutors compared the scheme to Madoff's fraud; seized assets - including mansions and a Bugatti supercar - will be used to repay victims.
 - **Guo had cultivated close ties to Trump's political circle:** He held a \$1 million consulting contract with Bannon and hosted Giuliani at his Manhattan penthouse during the 2020 presidential campaign.
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Guo Wengui, China critic and tycoon, sentenced to 30 years for fraud

- **Court ordered \$889 million forfeiture alongside Guo's 30-year fraud sentence:** Prosecutors argued he siphoned over \$1 billion from followers and compared his conduct to Madoff rather than crypto fraudster Bankman-Fried.
- **Beijing's extradition demand complicates Trump's pardon calculus:** China lists Guo among its leading criminal fugitives while allies including Steve Bannon publicly advocate for his release.

5. Strategic implications and responses

Why the US-China trade war lacks the guardrails of the past

- **Post-WWII trade war precedents relied on shared security alliances:** The author argues prior US disputes with Europe and Japan were bounded by military dependency - a constraint entirely absent from US-China competition.
 - **China's rare earth controls target production capacity, not market share:** With China supplying ~80% of neodymium magnets, export restrictions disrupt US and allied manufacturing of finished goods rather than competing with them directly.
 - **Both leaders treat the trade war as a test of personal legacy:** According to the author, perceived costs of backing down may outweigh mounting economic damage for both Trump and Xi, removing a key incentive for resolution.
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China is a winner of Iran conflict: Asia hand Kurt Campbell

- **A Hormuz disruption would hit US allies in Asia harder than it would hit China:** Campbell said Beijing's crude stockpiles and diversified supplier base leave it better insulated than Japan, South Korea, or Taiwan – the choke-point risk pushes pressure onto Washington's partners, not onto the rival Washington wants to constrain.
 - **The "clear strategic advantage" line is Asia Group's, not Campbell's own words:** Nikkei leans on a Washington consultancy report for the top-line "China wins" judgment; worth flagging when the framing is quoted downstream, since the strongest claim in the piece is sourced to the report rather than to the former deputy secretary of state.
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Can America avoid a Jack Ma moment?

- **US blocked Anthropic's Fable 5 for all noncitizens:** The June 12 directive barred foreign users and some Anthropic staff from access; partial restoration followed on June 26.
 - **Beijing blocked Manus's Meta acquisition and restricted AI researcher travel:** China also barred domestic firms from purchasing Nvidia chips and requires security assessments of frontier models, according to the authors.
 - **Authors warn US-AI lab tensions risk America's long-term edge:** Allies are questioning reliance on US AI models and foreign researchers in American labs are reconsidering their plans, the authors report.
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Don't Let China Stack the Deck

- **Nossel's core claim: diffusion beats capability because AI dependency is invisible:** Users do not notice which model runs behind a service the way they notice a Chinese-built port or 5G tower, so political pushback against Chinese AI never builds – and the marginal cost of pushing another copy abroad is near zero, letting Beijing scale faster than US chip controls can bite.
 - **The proposed compact: US AI plus Taiwanese chips in, guardrails on use out:** A White House-led “Global Empowerment Network for Accountable AI” – Commerce and State co-leading, with US tech firms, universities, and development finance agencies – would offer country-level packages of financing, training, and privacy conditions to states “clamouring for AI acceleration” where US firms already have a foothold.
 - **Stakes: whoever's models diffuse first sets the global governance baseline:** Nossel argues that once Chinese systems become the default in Southeast Asia and the Gulf, US export controls cannot recover the standard-setting ground – governance rules travel with the tools actually in use.
 - **Nossel proposes a "Global Empowerment Network for Accountable AI":** Country-specific compacts would pair US AI exports with financing, training, and privacy guardrails, targeting strategic partners in Southeast Asia and the Gulf.
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Opinion: What would multilateral 'AI arms control' look like?

- **Z.ai's GLM 5.2 described as matching leading US AI models:** Former Trump AI-and-crypto czar David Sacks (now PCAST co-chair) said the Chinese open-weight model equals current OpenAI and Anthropic systems.
 - **US-China AI safety talks discussed ahead of Xi-Trump summit:** Beijing reportedly engaged on the topic but has not agreed to formal negotiations, according to the article.
 - **Source-code secrecy makes AI arms control unverifiable:** The author argues neither side will share sensitive AI code, ruling out the compliance verification needed for any significant agreement.
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US lawmakers push for fewer tax breaks to reduce reliance on China technology

- **US tax bill targets firms using Chinese data technology:** Rep. Moran's act would deny bonus depreciation and R&D expensing to companies sourcing tech from foreign adversaries accessing American private data.
 - **Bipartisan panels frame China's data collection as a strategic threat:** Congressional committees argue Washington has failed to counter Beijing's data-acquisition drive, according to SCMP.
-

EU confronts 'China shock' ahead of pivotal Brussels trade talks

- **EU-China trade deficit widened sharply in 2025:** China's goods trade surplus with the EU reached €360.6bn in 2025 (+15% YoY per Eurostat); May 2026 EU imports from China rose 7.6% while exports fell 1.3%. Volkswagen reportedly planned up to 100,000 job cuts citing Chinese competition.
 - **European Commission is readying tariffs, quotas, and new trade instruments:** Sources say investigations in chemicals and machinery could begin before August, alongside a "solidarity mechanism" compensating firms hit by Chinese retaliation.
 - **Beijing rejected the EU's "China shock" framing at a Dalian forum:** Premier Li Qiang said Chinese technologies bring "opportunity not shock," while China's EU ambassador threatened countermeasures against de-risking measures.
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World Bank to phase out China lending

- **World Bank to end China lending by 2031:** The proposal caps remaining disbursements at \$2bn total and will be discussed by the board the week of July 20, according to the FT.
 - **US Treasury pressed other multilateral lenders to follow:** Washington named the Asian Development Bank and IFAD as institutions that should similarly phase out China development financing.
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Donald Trump is kicking out Chinese firms and keeping their tech - The Economist

- **US law bars China-linked firms from clean-energy tax subsidies:** Trump's One Big Beautiful Bill Act designates Chinese operators as "Foreign Entities of Concern," disqualifying them from Section 45X credits worth up to \$350m annually per large facility.
 - **Nearly \$9bn in Chinese renewables investment has been cancelled, paused or sold since 2025:** Assets have traded at discounts of up to 40%, with Boway selling its North Carolina factory for 15% below construction cost, according to The Economist.
 - **Ownership transfers obscure rather than resolve supply chain dependence:** Many joint ventures are described as superficial compliance structures, while China controls 95% of global polysilicon supply - the primary solar panel input.
-

Extreme Weather Will Upend U.S.-China Competition

- **China mobilised roughly \$23 billion for urban flood resilience between 2021 and 2025:** State Grid additionally plans \$570 billion in grid upgrades to maintain electricity reliability against extreme weather over the next five years.
 - **The US has no national adaptation strategy, the authors report:** The Trump administration has cut public access to climate data, abandoned corporate climate disclosure rules, and issued a resilience strategy that omits climate change entirely.
 - **Both countries' AI data centres face mounting climate exposure, according to XDI analysis:** Over 200 US data centres face significant hazard risk by midcentury, with nearly a quarter of China's also at high risk - concentrated in economic centres such as Shanghai and Jiangsu.
-

Agency amid asymmetry: how small European states shape relations with a rising China

- **Six-country finding: domestic politics – not Chinese leverage – set the terms:** Across Czechia, Ireland, Belgium, Hungary, Latvia, and Serbia, internal identity, institutional structure, and elite interests drive the China policy outcome; the vast power asymmetry has not delivered Beijing the results it wanted.
 - **Serbia turns great-power rivalry into room to manoeuvre:** Non-member Belgrade uses Chinese investment and political cover to resist Brussels' liberalisation pressure, exploiting the space that EU-China competition opens for a candidate country outside the club.
 - **Belgium shows EU and NATO membership is no automatic shield:** Federal fragmentation inside a full member undercuts a coherent China policy – alliance-level guardrails do not hold when the country's own institutions cannot pull in one direction.
-

China's push east of Taiwan tests Japan-Philippines deterrence

- **China Coast Guard asserts new territorial claim east of Taiwan:** Beijing deployed coast guard patrols beyond its "10-dash line" after Japan and the Philippines delimited their maritime boundaries there in late May, asserting sovereignty over waters not previously claimed, the article reports.
 - **The author argues China has learned that gray-zone reputational costs are negligible:** South China Sea experience shows Beijing can routinise naval and paramilitary presence with only condemnation and freedom-of-navigation responses, making smaller countries' acceptance of that presence a de facto outcome.
 - **Japan exports military equipment to regional partners for the first time since 1945:** Tokyo is supplying defense hardware to the Philippines, Australia, and New Zealand, positioning itself as the linchpin of an emerging Indo-Pacific security order, the article reports.
-

China's grip on global ship repair worries Japan. Can Tokyo end its dependence?

- **Japan's 370 trillion yen industrial plan allocates 100 billion yen to ship repair:** Tokyo's cabinet-approved strategy targets 17 strategic industries through 2040, financed through a mix of public and private investment.
 - **China accounts for 60 per cent of global ship repairs, handling most Japanese vessels:** Japan manages only 7 per cent of its own repairs, according to Chinese industry portal eWorldship, driving economic security concerns amid strained bilateral ties.
-

A Taiwan crisis is coming - and Xi may not wait

- **AEI author argues Taiwan's 2028 presidential election is the next likely crisis flashpoint:** The author contends Xi may escalate military and economic pressure around the election to force a government willing to accelerate unification.
- **"Customs quarantine" scenario presented as plausible coercion tool short of invasion:** The author describes selective harassment of air and maritime traffic as a mechanism Beijing could use to demonstrate its ability to suffocate Taiwan economically.
- **Trump administration urged to complete a \$14 billion arms sale and sanction China's access to jet engine components and semiconductors:** The author argues delayed arms transfers signal appeasement to Beijing and calls for intensified partner preparations with Japan.

IV. Chinese Sources

Regulatory & policy primary sources

NDRC (VIA NPCSC) · 24 JUN 2026

Unified national market: 'list of matters obstructing' + 'local fiscal-subsidy negative list' issued

- **Vice Chairman Li Chunlin confirmed both lists have been issued:** NDRC has distributed the two negative lists (kept internal) to discipline local government subsidies and market-access practices that undermine the unified national market policy line.
 - **Framing signals more central discipline over local subsidy-fuelled "involution":** The lists operationalize a directive that has been on paper since 2022; enforcement now shifts to the reporting/verification stage before eventual publication.
-

NPCSC · 23 JUN 2026

Draft revised PBoC Law released for public comment

- **Codifies PBoC's macroprudential lead role, structural monetary tools, and e-CNY:** The revision writes into statute what has been evolving in practice, formalizing PBoC's expanded post-2018 policy toolkit.
 - **Authorizes blocking orders and countermeasures against foreign financial sanctions:** New provisions give PBoC explicit statutory basis to respond to sanctions targeting Chinese entities via financial channels.
-

NPCSC · 26 JUN 2026

Draft revised Government Procurement Law opened for 30-day public comment

- **Writes fair-competition principles into the statute:** Foreign-invested firms are formally covered by procurement rules on equal footing with domestic firms – Beijing's answer to EU concerns about market access.
 - **Preserves power to ban "legally restricted" suppliers:** The same revision leaves a discretionary carve-out for national security or reciprocity grounds – a hedge MOFCOM has now used against US defence firms.
-

STATE COUNCIL · 29 JUN 2026

Education Development 15th Five-Year Plan (2026–2030)

- **Domestic software/hardware talent program + National Excellent Engineer Colleges buildout:** The plan pushes tertiary-education alignment with strategic technology self-sufficiency goals under the FYP.
 - **Top-university investment in "strategically must-contest fields" + ~300 basic-discipline top-student bases:** Explicit talent pipelines for chip, AI, biotech and other export-control-affected sectors.
-

15th Five-Year Plan for Building a Beautiful China

- **Seven environmental tasks through 2030 with expanded green fiscal, financial and pricing support:** Covers pollution control, ecosystem protection, climate response and industrial low-carbon transition.
 - **Ministry of Ecology and Environment flags pilots of a VOCs tax and research toward a solid-waste tax:** Explicit fiscal-revenue framing – local governments get new tax handles as part of the rollout.
-

RMB internationalization package unveiled at Lujiazui Forum

- **PBoC facility lets foreign central banks + SWFs borrow RMB against Chinese-bond collateral:** Governor Pan Gongsheng's announcement targets one of the classic barriers to reserve-currency use.
 - **SAFE announced fresh QDII quotas, streamlined outbound approvals, and eased foreign-currency loan rules:** Package widens capital-account convertibility on the outbound side while retaining discretion.
 - **Six major state commercial banks permitted CNH transactions directly from mainland HQ:** Replaces the earlier FTZ-branch/segregated-account channel with a mainland-based book, subject to quotas.
 - **HKMA to launch Chinese government bond futures in early August:** Adds a hedging instrument for the offshore CNY bond market.
-

Six-month 'special action' on merger control launched

- **Framed as supporting M&A and restructuring to escape "involution-style" competition:** The action aims to accelerate antitrust review for consolidation deals in oversupplied sectors.
 - **Antitrust-review green channel flagged for selected sectors:** A signal to industries facing chronic overcapacity (solar, batteries, EVs) that Beijing wants consolidation.
-

Annual audit report published

- **RMB 60 billion of inflated fiscal revenue across 21 provinces/municipalities:** The audit exposes systemic revenue manipulation through fake land deals, circular contracting and misclassified transfers.
- **17 counties packaged RMB 12.2 billion of low-return projects as self-sufficient SPBs:** Direct evidence of the mis-selling of special-purpose bonds the newsletter's B1 baskets have flagged all year.
- **6% of surveyed LGFVs gaming hidden-debt exit lists:** Continued weakness in the local-government debt cleanup despite the 2024 refinancing package.

Government positions & readouts

MOFCOM · 23 JUN 2026

46 US defence-linked companies banned from Chinese government procurement

- **First use of MOF procurement-law power against foreign vendors:** Beijing responded to Pentagon 1260H additions with an equivalent instrument on the procurement side.
 - **Signals institutionalization of "reciprocal" restrictions vocabulary:** MOFCOM increasingly matches US measures with mirror-image instruments rather than symmetric export controls alone.
-

STATE COUNCIL / MOFCOM · 23 JUN 2026

10 US companies added to China's export control list

- **Response to US Pentagon 1260H additions:** Includes Alibaba, Baidu, BYD, Nio, WuXi AppTec, Unitree, YMTC, and CXMT on the US side; MOFCOM added named US defence tech firms in return.
-

MOFCOM · 29 JUN 2026

Commerce Minister Wang Wentao–EU Trade Commissioner Šefčovič inaugural meeting in Brussels

- **First meeting of the new China-EU Trade and Investment Consultation Mechanism:** Establishes ministerial-level dialogue with a joint trade-flow monitoring mechanism.
 - **October deadline for "tangible results" set on Brussels side:** MOFCOM confirms one-to-two ministerial meetings per year going forward.
-

MFA · 30 JUN 2026

Wang Yi–Rubio phone call on Taiwan

- **First reported cabinet-level US-China call since Trump's mid-May Beijing visit:** Wang warned Washington to approach Taiwan affairs with “utmost caution”.
 - **Xinhua framed the call as "positive and constructive":** Beijing preserving the “strategic stability” language from the May summit.
-

MOFCOM · 2 JUL 2026

Spokesperson confirms agricultural products in US tariff-reduction framework

- **First official CN confirmation of agricultural inclusion in reciprocal tariff cuts:** He Yadong statement gives Beijing’s version of the framework Trump referenced separately.
-

CENTRAL MILITARY COMMISSION · 3 JUL 2026

Zhang Shuguang promoted to full general, head of CMC Discipline Inspection Commission

- **Xi conferred rank at formal ceremony:** Signals continuation of the anti-corruption drive under a trusted successor at CMCDI.
-

CENTRAL MILITARY COMMISSION · 3 JUL 2026

Wang Gang promoted to full general as new Air Force commander

- **Second full-general promotion at the same ceremony:** Fills the PLA Air Force top slot amid ongoing purges.
-

XI JINPING / CCP · 1 JUL 2026

Speech marking the CCP's 105th anniversary

- **"Adept at struggle" elevated as one of six "superior qualities":** Framing struggle as governing philosophy for the FYP transition.
-

CCP CENTRAL COMMITTEE · 30 JUN 2026

Annual membership bulletin

- **Total membership passed 101 million:** Share of under-35s down to 21.9%, college-educated up to 59%, women 31.5%, ethnic minorities 7.8% – demographic shift toward older, higher-educated urban cadre base.
-

SASAC / CCP ORGANIZATION DEPARTMENT · 30 JUN 2026

Cheng Fubo appointed SASAC Party secretary

- **55-year-old defense-industry veteran (ex-Norinco/AVIC chair):** Replaces Zhang Yuzhuo, who moved to head the Chinese Academy of Engineering.
-

MCA / CCP ORGANIZATION DEPARTMENT · 30 JUN 2026

Li Changguan appointed MCA Party secretary

- **57-year-old Guangxi Zhuang cadre:** Replaces Lu Zhiyuan, who took over the All-China Federation of Trade Unions.

Chinese thinking

AISIXIANG · 2 JUL 2026

Da Wei: The End of Hegemony and the Rebirth of Power: The United States at the 250th Anniversary of Its Founding

- **Da Wei argues US hegemony is ending from within:** MAGA, the article contends, represents a retreat from liberal-internationalist empire to nationalist-imperial logic, not from empire to republic.
 - **AI identified as America's most realistic path to power revival:** Da Wei argues the US retains deep capital markets, leading tech firms, and talent-attraction conditions to be among the new technological revolution's primary beneficiaries.
 - **US institutional hegemony seen as unrecoverable:** Even if American power revives, Da Wei argues the relative preponderance and international prestige of the post-WWII and post-Cold War eras cannot recur.
-

AISIXIANG · 1 JUL 2026

The Rise and Impact of the Global Anti-AI Wave

- **Anti-AI actions have escalated from elite petitions to arson and referenda:** The article documents Berlin power cable sabotage, Molotov attacks on OpenAI CEO Sam Altman's residence, and an 88.34% referendum vote banning data centres in Monterey Park, California.
 - **75 US data-centre projects were cancelled or postponed in Q1 2026 alone:** A Gallup poll found 70% of Americans oppose data-centre construction in their communities - up from nearly 50% at end-2025, the article reports.
 - **Article calls for mandatory pre-deployment ethics review over remedial regulation:** The piece argues that as AI approaches a "recursive self-improvement" tipping point, patch-style governance will fail, and calls for a global coordination mechanism on safety floors, ethical red lines, and transparency standards.
-

AISIXIANG · 30 JUN 2026

Fu Xiaoqiang: The Four Global Initiatives Drive the International Order Toward Greater Fairness and Rationality

- **Fu Xiaoqiang frames four global initiatives as a unified framework:** The piece presents BRI alongside GDI, GSI, GCI, and GGI as organically linking development, security, civilization, and governance into one system.
 - **Article contrasts Chinese approach with Western "zero-sum" and bloc-confrontation logic:** The piece grounds China's framework in "tianxia datong" (great harmony under heaven) and rejects what it calls civilizational-superiority narratives and hegemonic conditionality.
 - **BRI cited as reaching 150+ countries without political conditionality:** Flagship rail projects - China-Europe, China-Laos, Jakarta-Bandung - are presented as filling developing-country infrastructure gaps on equal, ideology-free terms.
-

Han Liang, Qiao Jihong, Zhu Ruiqing: Advancing the Development and Progress of Human Political Civilization with Chinese Wisdom — Xi Jinping's Party-Building Thought Brings Profound Inspiration to the World

- **Aisixiang frames Xi Jinping's party-building thought as a universal model:** The piece quotes officials from over a dozen countries calling it applicable beyond China, timed to the CPC's 105th anniversary.
- **CPC-world party contacts cited as evidence of international reach:** The article reports ties with over 700 parties in 170+ countries and three multilateral summits themed around “the responsibility of political parties.”
- **Article contrasts CPC model with Western party dysfunction:** It frames Western politics as beset by “partisan strife” and “the rise of populism,” positioning the CPC as a 21st-century alternative.

Tang Xiaosong, Zhu Haiming, Wang Yaping: Artificial Intelligence and the Transformation of Public Diplomacy

- **AI has shifted from auxiliary tool to internalized structural capability in public diplomacy:** The article traces three development phases since 2010, concluding that systematized AI foundations now run through listening, advocacy, and cultural diplomacy.
- **Three core public diplomacy mechanisms have each undergone AI-driven systemic restructuring:** Listening moved from sample-based monitoring to full-domain early warning, advocacy from periodic manual planning to algorithmic narrative engineering, and cultural diplomacy toward interactive value alignment.
- **The article identifies three unavoidable risks from AI adoption in public diplomacy:** Deepfakes erode diplomatic credibility, algorithmic filter bubbles deepen covertly, and dependence on foreign technology platforms creates structural fragility.

Wang Zhan and Li Yujing: Building the China-Africa Community of Shared Future from the Perspective of Area Studies

- **2024 FOCAC Summit elevated the concept to "all-weather" status:** The paper frames this upgrade as a regional demonstration of Xi's community of shared future for humankind and a paradigm for South-South cooperation research.
- **Area Studies designated a first-level discipline to serve national strategy:** Chinese academia is tasked with building an “autonomous knowledge system with Chinese characteristics” using China-Africa cooperation as its theoretical anchor.
- **Four pillars structure the concept's "scientific connotations":** The paper identifies major-country diplomacy, the BRI, the community of shared future framework, and the “sincerity, real results, amity, good faith” Africa policy as mutually reinforcing dimensions.

CN coverage of EU/GER

XINHUA · 30 JUN 2026

China, EU officially launch trade, investment consultation mechanism

- **First joint statement in seven years:** Beijing frames the launch as evidence of “importance of dialogue” – a direct contrast to Brussels’ harder October-deadline framing.
 - **Four workstreams named:** trade balancing, export controls, IPR, WTO reform – mirroring the Šefčovič talking points but framed as mutual accommodation rather than one-way concessions.
-

GLOBAL TIMES · 29 JUN 2026

Editorial: Genuine dialogue or more tariff walls? Europe needs to drop two-faced game

- **Positions Brussels' October ultimatum as bad faith:** Frames EU trade defense as protectionism wearing rules-based clothing.
-

CHINA DAILY · 28 JUN 2026

China Daily editorial: EU's use of maximum pressure belies its faith in talks

- **Reads Brussels' new instruments (supplier diversification + retaliation solidarity) as adversarial:** Direct engagement with Šefčovič’s June speech language.
-

QIUSHI · 29 JUN 2026

Why Europe's politics is shifting to the right

- **Party-theoretical journal offers a structural read of European political drift:** Frames the rise of right-wing forces as intrinsic to Western democratic decay, aligning with the Aisixiang Da Wei theme this week.
-

PEOPLE'S DAILY (OPINION) · 1 JUL 2026

Chinese air conditioners cool Europe, showing more than trade: China-style empowerment

- **Uses the AC-export boom during Europe's heatwave as a soft-power narrative:** Positions Chinese manufacturing as a public good filling gaps European industry cannot – a preview of the response line to EU AC-export scrutiny.
-

XINHUA (GLOBAL TIMES ECHO) · 2 JUL 2026

Wang Yi visit to Denmark, Sweden, Finland, Norway

- **First official framing of the Nordic tour:** Beijing’s version of a “listening tour” to Europe’s most China-critical governments while Berlin/Brussels harden.

Caveat: nur stichprobenartig auf Qualität / Richtigkeit überprüft — Coverage nur bis 5. Juli 2026.

1. Prominente Zitate und Positionen zu China-bezogenen Angelegenheiten

FAZ.NET · 29 JUN 2026

Maros Sefcovic EU-Handelskommissar betonte am Montag, den 29.06. in Brüssel nach Gesprächen mit Chinas Handelsminister Wang Wentao, das EU-Handelsdefizit mit China von 360 Mrd. EUR sei nicht hinnehmbar: „Diese Entwicklung ist nicht nachhaltig und ein Festhalten am Status quo ist keine Option“ – und setzte eine Oktober-Deadline für „greifbare Ergebnisse“ in vier Arbeitsgruppen, bevor er nach China reist.

“EU will bis Oktober Ergebnisse; Deadline im Handelsstreit”

WELT.DE · 2 JUL 2026

Wang Wentao Handelsminister, Volksrepublik China erklärte am Sonntag, den 28.06. beim Treffen mit Bundeswirtschaftsministerin Reiche in Brüssel, China hoffe auf eine aktive Rolle Deutschlands in der EU, um Brüssel zu einer «rationalen Haltung» in der Handelspolitik gegenüber China zu bewegen.

“Nach Treffen mit Reiche: China mahnt Deutschland zu Fairness”

WELT.DE · 2 JUL 2026

He Yadong Sprecher des chinesischen Handelsministeriums forderte am Donnerstag in Peking, Deutschland und China sollten freien Handel unterstützen, den gegenseitigen Marktzugang ausweiten und ein faires, offenes und diskriminierungsfreies Geschäftsklima für die Zusammenarbeit zwischen Unternehmen schaffen.

“Nach Treffen mit Reiche: China mahnt Deutschland zu Fairness”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 30 JUN 2026

Bundesamt für Verfassungsschutz BfV Im am Dienstag von Innenminister Alexander Dobrindt (CSU) und BfV-Präsident Sinan Selen in Berlin vorgestellten Verfassungsschutzbericht 2025, wird China neben Russland und dem Iran als einer der drei Hauptakteure nachrichtendienstlicher Aktivitäten gegen Deutschland eingeordnet; China strebe bis 2049 eine globale Technologieführerschaft an und betreibe dafür ein umfassendes System des Technologie- und Know-how-Transfers.

“Verfassungsschutz mahnt Forscher zur Vorsicht bei China-Kontakten”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 1 JUL 2026

Maros Sefcovic EU-Handelskommissar erklärte am Dienstag zur neuen EU-Stahlschutzverordnung, welche die Importkontingente halbiert und den Zusatzzoll auf 50 Prozent verdoppelt: Wir bieten den Marktteilnehmern Vorhersehbarkeit durch klare und transparente Regeln für die Quotenverteilung.

“Die EU schützt ihre Stahlhersteller”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026

Michael Kretschmer Ministerpräsident Sachsen, CDU warnte am Samstag, den 27.06. nach Bekanntwerden der VW-Pläne zum Abbau von bis zu 100.000 Stellen und der Schließung von vier deutschen Werken – ausgelöst durch den Einbruch in China – vor einem fatalen Signal für ganz Deutschland.

“Volkswagen will weitere Zehntausende Stellen streichen”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026

Olaf Lies Ministerpräsident Niedersachsen, SPD kündigte am Samstag, den 27.06. als VW-Aufsichtsratsmitglied an, keiner Entwicklung zuzustimmen, die auf Werksschließungen „als vermeintlich einfache Lösung setzt oder die bewährte Mitbestimmung infrage stellt“.

“Volkswagen will weitere Zehntausende Stellen streichen”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026

Moritz Schularick Präsident, Kieler Institut für Weltwirtschaft warnte im Interview vom Samstag, den 27.06. eindringlich: „China und die USA werden Europa aufessen, Stück für Stück“ – und prognostizierte: „VW wird wahrscheinlich von einem chinesischen Autohersteller aufgekauft.“ Er forderte, den Zugang zum europäischen Binnenmarkt als Verhandlungsmasse gegenüber Peking einzusetzen. „Wir werden das tun, was die Chinesen mit uns gemacht haben.“

“China und die USA werden Europa aufessen, Stück für Stück”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026

Niall Ferguson Wirtschaftshistoriker, Stanford University warnte am Samstag, den 27.06. im Interview mit der Süddeutschen Zeitung: „Die deutsche Wirtschaft hat die Bedrohung durch China völlig unterschätzt“ und prognostizierte, ohne radikalen Wandel würden die Europäer sehr bald massenweise chinesische Autos fahren.

“China und die USA werden Europa aufessen, Stück für Stück”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 30 JUN 2026

Martin Keller Präsident, Helmholtz-Gemeinschaft erklärte am Dienstag im Interview zum Cisca-Datenschutzskandal in Saarbrücken: „Die Reputation des Forschungsstandortes steht auf dem Spiel“ und mahnte: „Wissenschaftsfreiheit endet spätestens dort, wo uns die Nutzung unserer Forschung durch andere Staaten gefährden könnte.“

“Reputation des Forschungsstandortes steht auf dem Spiel”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 29 JUN 2026

Bundesministerium für Forschung und Technologie BMFTR Sprecherin erklärte am Montag, den 29.06., zur Cisca-Affäre: „Wissenschaftsfreiheit bedeutet nicht Spionagefreiheit“ und fügte hinzu: „Die Zeitenwende bedeutet hier konkret, dass in der internationalen Zusammenarbeit mit autoritären Staaten im Spannungsfeld von angestrebtem Nutzen und potenziellen Risiken immer häufiger zugunsten der Sicherheit der Bundesrepublik Deutschland entschieden werden muss.“

“KPMG-Forensiker sollen möglichen Datenabfluss nach China prüfen”

SPIEGEL.DE · 29 JUN 2026

Paul Krugman Ökonom, Nobelpreisträger warnte laut Spiegel am Montag, den 29.06., EU-Zölle auf billige chinesische Autos seien möglicherweise das Gebot der Stunde, denn „die Europäer können nicht zulassen, dass ihre Autoindustrie komplett entkernt wird.“

“Wer ist nerviger – Trump oder China?”

WELT AM SONNTAG · 28 JUN 2026

Angelika El-Noshokaty Geschäftsführerin, Verband Aluminium Deutschland warnte laut Welt am Sonntag, die Unternehmen in Europa könnten ihre Kosten kaum decken, während chinesische Rivalen das dank Subventionen könnten: „Wir sind in einem Existenzkampf, in dem wir politische Unterstützung brauchen. Wenn die EU nichts unternimmt, hören die einheimischen Unternehmen auf zu existieren.“

“China schlängelt sich immer wieder durch”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 29 JUN 2026

Ralf Sauter Partner, Horváth erklärte am Montag, den 29.06., auf Basis einer Umfrage unter 1.000 deutschen Unternehmen, die mehrheitlich Stellenabbau und Verlagerungen planen: „Das Modell der deutschen Exportnation war jahrzehntelang ein Erfolg. Jetzt läuft es aus.“

“Raus aus Deutschland – bis zu 100.000 Jobs sind in Gefahr”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 30 JUN 2026

Jan Mischke Partner, McKinsey Global Institute erklärte am Dienstag auf Basis einer McKinsey-Studie, die Deutschland mit produktiven Nettoinvestitionen von nur 0,2 Prozent des BIP auf dem letzten Platz unter 34 Ländern – weit hinter Chinas 23 Prozent – sieht: „Produktive Nettoinvestitionen, das klingt abstrakt. Aber sie sind einer der wichtigsten Indikatoren für das zukünftige Wachstum und die Wettbewerbsfähigkeit eines Landes.“

“Investitions-Boykott in Deutschland”

FAZ.NET · 2 JUL 2026

William Yang Senior Analyst, Crisis Group erklärte am Donnerstag zu Xi Jinpings globalen Initiativen und Chinas strategischer Nutzung der Schwächung des Westens unter Trump: „China verfolgt mit diesen Initiativen klare strategische Ziele: eine alternative Weltordnung voranzutreiben, die die bestehende, von den USA und anderen westlichen Demokratien geführte und dominierte globale Ordnung herausfordert“.

“China beobachtet ‘Amerika vs. Amerika’”

WELT.DE · 2 JUL 2026

Gabriel Wildau China-Analyst, Teneo kommentierte in einem am Donnerstag nach den Brüsseler EU-China-Handelsgesprächen erschienenen Artikel die gewachsene Entschlossenheit europäischer Regierungen: „Angesichts der Bedrohung für die europäische Industrie scheint unter europäischen Staats- und Regierungschefs das Gefühl der Dringlichkeit einen Umkehrpunkt erreicht zu haben.“

“Nach Treffen mit Reiche: China mahnt Deutschland zu Fairness”

WIWO.DE · 30 JUN 2026

Covestro kündigte am Dienstag per Pressemitteilung den Ausbau seiner MDI-Produktion am Standort Shanghai an und prüft zusätzlich eine weitere MDI-Anlage in den Vereinigten Arabischen Emiraten. Konzernchef Markus Steilemann bezifferte das mögliche Investitionsvolumen beider Projekte gegenüber der Financial Times auf bis zu vier Milliarden Euro. Covestro bezeichnete China zudem als „weltweit größten MDI-Markt und wichtigsten Treiber des zukünftigen Nachfragewachstums“.

“Erst BASF, jetzt Covestro – China wird zum Notnagel der deutschen Chemieindustrie”

WELT.DE · 29 JUN 2026

Zack Zhang Managing Director, Geely Auto Deutschland erklärte in einem am Montag, den 29.06., veröffentlichten Interview beim Brandlaunch des Geely E5 in Raunheim bei Frankfurt, die Strategie „Local for Local“ sei langfristig: Geely komme nicht nach Europa, um Fahrzeuge einfach zu importieren, sondern wolle hier entwickeln, produzieren und Arbeitsplätze schaffen. Zudem betonte er: „Langfristiger Erfolg entsteht nicht über Rabatte, sondern über zufriedene Kunden.“

“Erfolg entsteht nicht über Rabatte”

HANDELSBLATT · 29 JUN 2026

Andreas Kroll CEO, Noble Elements erklärte am Montag, den 29.06., im Handelsblatt-Interview, dass seit April 2024 keine schweren seltenen Erden für die Rüstung mehr China verließen. Noble Elements sei für die Rüstungsindustrie inzwischen komplett unabhängig von China aufgestellt: „Wir haben bereits vor mehr als einem Jahr begonnen, uns bei immer mehr seltenen Erden und Technologiemetallen unabhängig von China zu machen.“

“Die Amerikaner und Japaner kaufen gerade den Markt leer”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 30 JUN 2026

Tim Kurth Produktionsvorstand, Aurubis betonte zur Eröffnung der neuen Recyclinganlage CRH in Hamburg am 3. Juli, mit der der Konzern auch auf den chinesischen Wettbewerb um europäischen Metallschrott reagiert: „Mit CRH verschieben wir die Grenze dessen, was wir im eigenen Netzwerk verarbeiten können. So verbleibt mehr Wert im Unternehmen.“

“Die Antwort von Aurubis auf die Konkurrenz aus China”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 30 JUN 2026

Hochrangiger EU-Beamter EU-Kommission erklärte am Dienstag/30.06. bei der Vorstellung der neuen Stahlimportquoten, die China auf 35,8 Prozent seiner durchschnittlichen EU-Lieferungen der Jahre 2022 bis 2024 begrenzen: „Das waren keine einfachen Gespräche, weil wir einen kleineren Kuchen aufteilen. Deshalb werden die Stücke, die wir aus diesem Kuchen schneiden, zwangsläufig für jedes Land kleiner.“

“Wer darf künftig noch Stahl nach Europa liefern?”

2. Wichtige China-bezogene Entwicklungen in Fakten und Zahlen

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026

Deutschland verliert monatlich mehr als 10.000 Industriearbeitsplätze: Vor allem an die chinesische Konkurrenz verliert die deutsche Industrie gerade mehr als 10.000 Stellen pro Monat.

“Deutschland verliert zehntausend Arbeitsplätze im Monat”

FAZ.NET · 1 JUL 2026

VW erwägt weltgrößte Restrukturierung der Autogeschichte: Volkswagen erwägt, die bereits beschlossenen 50.000 Stellenstreichungen auf bis zu 100.000 Stellen weltweit zu verdoppeln – das entspräche rund 15 Prozent der über 667.000 Beschäftigten – und vier deutsche Werke zu schließen.

“Die zweite China-Welle rollt auf die deutsche Industrie zu”

FAZ.NET · 1 JUL 2026

VW verliert China-Marktführerschaft, Verkäufe brechen um 20 Prozent ein: Volkswagen fiel 2025 in China auf Rang drei zurück; im ersten Quartal 2026 brachen die dortigen Verkäufe um 20 Prozent ein, womit die einst dominante Marktführerschaft im weltgrößten Automarkt unerreichbar geworden scheint.

“Die zweite China-Welle rollt auf die deutsche Industrie zu”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE SONNTAGSZEITUNG · 28 JUN 2026

90 Prozent der 5,8 Milliarden EU-Kleinsendungen stammen aus China: Etwa 5,8 Milliarden Kleinsendungen unter 150 Euro wurden 2025 in die EU eingeführt; schätzungsweise 90 Prozent davon stammten aus China – Anlass für den neuen Pauschalzoll von drei Euro pro Warenkategorie ab 1. Juli 2026.

“Jetzt werden Pakete teurer”

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 1 JUL 2026

EU verdoppelt Stahl-Schutzzoll auf 50 Prozent bei weltweiter Überkapazität von 620

Millionen Tonnen: Die EU halbiert die Stahlimportquote und verdoppelt den Zusatzzoll auf 50 Prozent; globale Überkapazitäten liegen laut Kommission bei 620 Millionen Tonnen jährlich und sind ein wesentlicher Treiber der chinesischen Exportflut.

“Die EU schützt ihre Stahlhersteller”

HANDELSBLATT.COM · 30 JUN 2026

Chinas Industrie-PMI steigt im Juni auf 50,3, Hightech-Fertigung auf 53,5:

Der offizielle Einkaufsmanagerindex für das verarbeitende Gewerbe kletterte im Juni auf 50,3 (Mai: 50,0), der PMI für die Hightech-Fertigung lag bei 53,5 – getragen von einem erneuten Exportboom, der die schwache Binnennachfrage ausgleicht.

“Exportboom treibt Wirtschaft im Juni an”

DIE WELT · 30 JUN 2026

Chinas Geburtenrate sinkt auf 1,01 – zweitniedrigster Wert weltweit: Die Geburtenrate der Volksrepublik fiel von rund sechs Kindern je Frau in den 1960er-Jahren über 2,25 in den 1990ern auf 1,01 im Jahr 2024 – dem zweitniedrigsten Wert der Welt hinter Südkorea – mit langfristigen Folgen auch für die Volksbefreiungsarmee.

“Die große Schwäche von Chinas Militär”

DER TAGESSPIEGEL · 29 JUN 2026

Nur 16 Prozent der Deutschen vertrauen Trump – gegenüber 28 Prozent für Xi Jinping: Laut einer Umfrage des Pew Research Center vertrauen nur 16 Prozent der deutschen Befragten dem US-Präsidenten, während es beim chinesischen Staatschef 28 Prozent sind – fast doppelt so viele.

“Deutsche vertrauen Chinas Xi mehr als Trump”

FAZ.NET · 30 JUN 2026

Covestro plant MDI-Großanlage in Shanghai: 660.000 Tonnen Jahreskapazität, bis zu 2 Milliarden Euro Investition: Der Leverkusener Konzern plant am Standort Shanghai eine neue MDI-Anlage mit einer Kapazität von 660.000 Tonnen jährlich; branchenüblich kostet eine solche Anlage anderthalb bis zwei Milliarden Euro.

“Neue MDI-Anlage: Covestro investiert Milliarden in China”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 3 JUL 2026

China stellte 2025 ein Drittel der meistzitierten KI-Forschungspapiere – 12 Prozentpunkte mehr als die USA: zugleich hat sich die Aktie des chinesischen KI-Unternehmens Zhipu AI seit seinem Börsengang versechzehnfacht.

“China jagt die USA im KI-Rennen”

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 30 JUN 2026

Mehr als eine Million tibetische Kinder in Mandarin-Internaten: Schon vor der Einführung des seit dem 1. Juli geltenden Gesetz zur „Förderung der ethnischen Einheit“ werden mehr als eine Million tibetischer Kinder in Internaten unterrichtet, in denen der Unterricht hauptsächlich auf Mandarin stattfindet.

“Fremde Federn: Ein Sondergesandter für Tibet”

BILD PLUS · 1 JUL 2026

VW-Entwicklerstunde in China kostet 60 Euro – halb so viel wie in Deutschland, ein Drittel des Rivian-Satzes: Nach internen VW-Zahlen kostet eine Entwicklerstunde in China rund 60 Euro; in Deutschland sind es etwa 120 Euro, beim Joint Venture mit Rivian werden 200 Dollar angesetzt – ein Milliardenvorteil, der den Konzern zur Prüfung chinesischer Technik für Europa treibt.

„Rettet dieser geheime China-Plan deutsche VW-Jobs?“

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 1 JUL 2026

Gree-Chefin Dong Mingzhu: 190 Milliarden Yuan Umsatz 2024 – weltgrößter Klimaanlagehersteller: Gree Electric unter Führung von Dong Mingzhu erzielte 2024 einen Umsatz von rund 190 Milliarden Yuan (gut 24 Milliarden Euro) und ist gemessen an der Stückzahl der weltweit größte Hersteller von Haushaltsklimaanlagen.

„PROFIL: Dong Mingzhu“

SPIEGEL PLUS · 27 JUN 2026

Stand-up-Comedy in China boomt: Shows +50 Prozent, 600.000 Tickets, 8 Milliarden Streams: Die Zahl der Stand-up-Comedy-Shows stieg im ersten Halbjahr 2025 im Vergleich zum Vorjahr um mehr als 50 Prozent; mehr als 600.000 Menschen kauften Tickets; die Comedysendung „Roast!“ wurde im Internet 8 Milliarden Mal aufgerufen – trotz verschärfter Zensur.

„Comedy in China“

3. Fünf zentrale Themen in der deutschen China-Politik Diskussion

China-Schock trifft die Koalition

Chinesische Überkapazitäten, staatliche Subventionen und aggressive Preisgestaltung kosten Deutschland laut Süddeutscher Zeitung zehntausend Industriearbeitsplätze pro Monat – branchenübergreifend. Das Handelsblatt berichtet, dass der China-Schock inzwischen die Koalitionsspitzen beschäftigt und parallel zum Reformgipfel eine härtere Handelspolitik gegenüber Peking diskutiert wurde. Der Tagesspiegel beziffert das Risiko auf bis zu 100.000 Industriejobs, die durch den kombinierten Druck aus China-Konkurrenz und heimischem Sparkurs gefährdet sind.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026 *„Deutschland verliert zehntausend Arbeitsplätze im Monat“*

HANDELSBLATT · 30 JUN 2026 *„Industrielle Basis erodiert‘ – China-Schock beschäftigt Koalitionsspitzen“*

DER TAGESSPIEGEL · 2 JUL 2026 *„Bis zu 100.000 Industriejobs durch Sparkurs in Gefahr“*

VW-Krise

Werksschließungen und letzte Tabus: Volkswagen droht die Produktion in vier deutschen Fabriken auslaufen zu lassen, falls diese ihre Kostenziele nicht erreichen. Genannt werden Emden, Hannover, Zwickau und Neckarsulm; zusätzlich steht Osnabrück in anderen Berichten im Fokus. Außerdem drohen weitere Zehntausende Stellenstreichungen – ein Einschnitt, der laut FAZ politische Alarmreaktionen hervorrief. Die Welt am Sonntag stellt offen die Frage, ob 100.000 Stellen wegfallen, während der Spiegel bilanziert, dass in der Automobilindustrie die letzten Tabus fallen: VW will Werke loswerden, Mercedes strebt die Rückkehr zur 40-Stunden-Woche an. Im Hintergrund steht die Debatte, ob der Import oder die Fertigung chinesischer VW-Modelle in Europa den Konzern retten kann.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

FRANKFURTER ALLGEMEINE ZEITUNG · 27 JUN 2026 *“Volkswagen will weitere Zehntausende Stellen streichen”*

WELT AM SONNTAG · 28 JUN 2026 *“Neue Sparpläne: Streicht VW 100.000 Stellen?”*

DER SPIEGEL · 3 JUL 2026 *“Industrie: Schwarzer Freitag”*

EU-China-Handelskonflikt

Oktober-Deadline gesetzt: Nach Gesprächen zwischen EU-Handelskommissar Maroš Šefčovič und Chinas Handelsminister Wang Wentao will die EU-Kommission bis Oktober konkrete Ergebnisse in den Verhandlungen mit China erzielen. Im Zentrum stehen der Abbau von Ungleichgewichten bei Handel und Investitionen, Exportkontrollen, geistiges Eigentum und WTO-Reform; Hintergrund sind wachsende Spannungen über Handelsdefizit, Subventionen, Überkapazitäten und Rohstoffkontrollen. Die taz argumentiert, Deutschland brauche den Dialog mit China, aber nur mit europäischer Rückendeckung aus Regeln und eigener industrieller Stärke. Die SZ beschreibt eine EU auf Kollisionskurs mit Peking, während Kanzler Merz chinesischen Wettbewerb erstmals öffentlich als „unfair“ bezeichnet.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

TAZ · 27 JUN 2026 *“Mit Peking reden, Brüssel stärken”*

FAZ.NET · 29 JUN 2026 *“EU will bis Oktober Ergebnisse: Deadline im Handelsstreit”*

SÜDDEUTSCHE ZEITUNG · 1 JUL 2026 *“Brüssel und Peking auf Kollisionskurs”*

Autonomes Fahren

China fährt davon, Deutschland verliert den Anschluss: Während das chinesische Start-up Momenta mit autonomen Fahrtechnologien an die Börse strebt und autonome Fahrzeuge in China sowie den USA bereits im Regelbetrieb fahren, beenden Volkswagen und Bosch ihre gemeinsame Allianz für selbstfahrende Systeme. Die Welt stellt fest, dass Deutschland trotz einer Strategie von 2015 zur Innovationsführerschaft beim automatisierten Fahren inzwischen zurückgefallen ist und vor allem in Pilotprojekten verharret. Der Spiegel beschreibt deutsche und europäische Anbieter wie Edgar und Moia als mögliche Hoffnungsträger einer Aufholjagd, betont aber zugleich den großen Rückstand gegenüber den USA und China.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

SPIEGEL PLUS · 28 JUN 2026

“Aufholjagd bei Robotaxis: Edgar und Moia – Deutschlands Hoffnung beim autonomen Fahren”

FAZ.NET · 29 JUN 2026 *“Autonomes Fahren; Volkswagen und Bosch geben auf – China fährt davon”*

WELT.DE · 29 JUN 2026 *“Im Milliarden-Rennen um Robotaxis fährt Deutschland nur hinterher”*

Deutsche Chemieriesen wählen China statt Deutschland

Covestro investiert Milliarden in eine neue MDI-Großanlage in Shanghai – weil China der weltgrößte Markt für das Schaumstoff-Vorprodukt ist und Deutschland als Investitionsstandort unattraktiv geworden ist. Die Wirtschaftswoche fasst das strukturelle Dilemma zusammen: Nach BASF setzt nun Covestro auf China als „Notnagel“ der deutschen Chemieindustrie, trotz Überkapazitäten und ruinösem Preiskampf vor Ort. Das Handelsblatt zitiert Konzernchef Steilemann mit der impliziten Botschaft, dass neue Großanlagen nicht in Deutschland entstehen werden.

PROMINENTE QUELLEN

WIRTSCHAFTSWOCHE · 30 JUN 2026

“Erst BASF, jetzt Covestro – China wird zum Notnagel der deutschen Chemieindustrie”

FAZ.NET · 30 JUN 2026 *“Covestro investiert Milliarden in China”*

HANDELSBLATT · 30 JUN 2026 *“Covestro: Konzern plant Großinvestitionen in China und am Persischen Golf”*